

# **Food and beverage consumption trends following KOLs: an explosive phenomenon in Vietnam**

**Bachelor Thesis**

**Supervisor:**

**Doc. Ing. Jana Turčínková, Ph.D.**

**Chi Mai Nguyen**

**Brno 2024**



**Acknowledgement**

First and foremost, I would like to express my profound gratitude and sincere thanks to my supervisor – Doc. Ing. Jana Turčínková, Ph.D., who spent a lot of her time and effort to contribute valuable insights for the research from its inception. Her dedication and contributions have greatly aided me in completing this thesis.

Furthermore, I would like to extend my thanks to the interviewees and respondents who shared their valuable opinions to assist me in this research endeavour.

Finally, I want to convey my heartfelt thanks to my parents, my family, my friends, and most especially to shark-head that has always encouraged me throughout the thesis completion process.



### **Statutory declaration**

I hereby declare that this thesis entitled: **Food and beverage consumption trends following KOLs: an explosive phenomenon in Vietnam** was written and completed by me. I also declare that all the sources and information used to complete the thesis are included in the list of references. I agree that the thesis could be made public in accordance with Article 47b of Act No. 111/1998 Coll., Higher Education Institutions and on Amendments and Supplements to Some Other Acts (the Higher Education Act), and in accordance with the current Directive on publishing of the final thesis.

I am aware that my thesis is written in accordance with Act. 121/2000 Coll., on Copyright and therefore Mendel University in Brno has the right to conclude licence agreements on the utilization of the thesis as a schoolwork in accordance with Article 60(1) of the Copyright Act.

Before concluding a licence agreement on utilization of the work by another person, I will request a written statement from the university that the licence agreement is not in contradiction to legitimate interests of the university, and I will also pay a prospective fee to cover the cost incurred in creating the work to the full amount of such costs.

In Brno on 12<sup>th</sup> May, 2024

---





# Contents

|          |                                                              |           |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>Introduction</b>                                          | <b>12</b> |
| <b>2</b> | <b>Objective</b>                                             | <b>14</b> |
| <b>3</b> | <b>Literature review</b>                                     | <b>15</b> |
| 3.1      | Consumer behaviour.....                                      | 15        |
| 3.1.1    | Consumer purchasing decision-making process .....            | 15        |
| 3.1.2    | Factors influencing consumer behaviour .....                 | 17        |
| 3.2      | Food and Beverage market.....                                | 20        |
| 3.2.1    | Characteristics of Food and Beverage industry .....          | 20        |
| 3.2.2    | Food and Beverage market in Vietnam .....                    | 22        |
| 3.3      | Social media influencers.....                                | 23        |
| 3.3.1    | Key Opinion Leader.....                                      | 23        |
| 3.3.2    | Influence of KOL in F&B consumption.....                     | 23        |
| 3.3.3    | Key Opinion Consumer .....                                   | 25        |
| 3.3.4    | Type of influencers .....                                    | 25        |
| 3.4      | Influencer marketing.....                                    | 25        |
| 3.4.1    | Word-of-mouth marketing.....                                 | 26        |
| 3.4.2    | Utilizing KOL for influencer marketing in F&B industry ..... | 26        |
| 3.4.3    | Influencer marketing for F&B industry in Vietnam.....        | 28        |
| 3.4.4    | Types of content .....                                       | 29        |
| <b>4</b> | <b>Method and materials</b>                                  | <b>31</b> |
| 4.1      | In-depth interviews.....                                     | 31        |
| 4.1.1    | Data collection method .....                                 | 31        |
| 4.1.2    | Sampling .....                                               | 32        |
| 4.1.3    | Interview guide .....                                        | 33        |
| 4.2      | Online questionnaire survey.....                             | 34        |
| 4.2.1    | Data collection method .....                                 | 34        |
| 4.2.2    | Questionnaire generation.....                                | 34        |

|           |                                                              |           |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 4.2.3     | Respondents' sociodemographic characteristics.....           | 35        |
| 4.3       | Observation.....                                             | 36        |
| 4.4       | Obstacles and solutions.....                                 | 37        |
| 4.5       | Data process .....                                           | 37        |
| <b>5</b>  | <b>Results</b>                                               | <b>38</b> |
| 5.1       | Social media platform preferences for following KOLs .....   | 38        |
| 5.2       | Consumption situation following KOLs .....                   | 39        |
| 5.2.1     | Purchase and experience following KOLs.....                  | 39        |
| 5.2.2     | Consumption following popular trends on social media .....   | 41        |
| 5.3       | Factors of KOLs influence consumer's purchase intention..... | 44        |
| 5.3.1     | Trustworthiness of KOLs.....                                 | 44        |
| 5.3.2     | Popularity of KOLs .....                                     | 45        |
| 5.3.3     | Expertise of KOLs in F&B field .....                         | 46        |
| 5.3.4     | Highly authentic content of KOLs.....                        | 47        |
| 5.3.5     | KOLs' appearance.....                                        | 48        |
| 5.3.6     | Interaction of KOL's followers.....                          | 49        |
| 5.3.7     | Consumer's fondness for KOLs .....                           | 50        |
| 5.3.8     | KOLs' private life scandals .....                            | 50        |
| <b>6</b>  | <b>Recommendations</b>                                       | <b>52</b> |
| 6.1       | KOL marketing.....                                           | 52        |
| 6.1.1     | Utilize suitable social media platforms.....                 | 52        |
| 6.1.2     | Choose suitable KOLs.....                                    | 52        |
| 6.1.3     | Control output of content.....                               | 54        |
| 6.2       | Following popular trends is potential .....                  | 54        |
| <b>7</b>  | <b>Discussion</b>                                            | <b>56</b> |
| <b>8</b>  | <b>Conclusion</b>                                            | <b>57</b> |
| <b>9</b>  | <b>References</b>                                            | <b>59</b> |
| <b>10</b> | <b>List of figures</b>                                       | <b>64</b> |
| <b>11</b> | <b>List of tables</b>                                        | <b>65</b> |

|                                                    |           |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Contents                                           | 11        |
| <b>A Online questionnaire survey in Vietnamese</b> | <b>67</b> |
| <b>B Online questionnaire survey in English</b>    | <b>76</b> |

# 1 Introduction

We all know that the human need for food and beverage has appeared naturally since the early days of human civilization. That is reflected in the fact that throughout our history of development, humans spent most of their time finding, processing and consuming food and beverage. Maslow classified the need for food and beverage consumption as the basic needs located at the bottom level, which is the position that people have priority to fulfil. Humans consume food and drinks, which, in turn, provide humans with energy to maintain life and develop physically and mentally. Over time, people's need to enjoy food and drinks also increases with the quality of life. For those reasons, the food and beverage (hereinafter F&B) market has become a continuously growing, potential, diverse and highly competitive market.

In the eyes of businesses and young start-up entrepreneurs, F&B is considered as an attractive business field with the advantage of fast capital turnover and increasing consumer demand. However, carrying out a business in the F&B field appears straightforward, but it is extremely intense and difficult in nowadays competitive context. According to Mr. Nguyen Huu Kien – Director of Refber Vietnam Co., Ltd., more than 80% of restaurants and cafes that open have difficulty or loss in the first 6 months to 1 year of operation (Kim, 2016).

After the Covid-19 pandemic broke out, every aspect of life in Vietnam was strongly affected. It brings negative impacts to the economy in general and the F&B industry in particular. In addition, that result has created a significant change in the consumption habits of Vietnamese. The economic situation and reduced personal income of consumers make them tighten their spending and that caused great challenges for businesses. In a challenging market context, businesses need to be more flexible in reaching consumers. Combined with the development of e-commerce and the explosion of social networks, influencer marketing utilizing KOLs is widely used and has become a new trend for businesses in Vietnam.

From a general perspective, consumers' purchase intention is significantly influenced by the experiences and reviews of KOLs. Comprehending the relationship between the influence of KOLs and consumers' purchasing intentions plays an important role in the success of business marketing campaign. Therefore, the purpose of this thesis is to provide an overview of the consumption situation following KOLs in Vietnam and discover the key factors of KOLs that influence consumers' purchase intentions as well as clarify the relationship of the influence of KOLs and consumers' purchasing intentions. Simultaneously, the results of previous related studies will be inherited to conduct Chi-Square test of independence the model to determine the relationship between the influence of KOLs and consumers' purchasing intentions. This study will collect data from consumers across Vietnam through in-depth interviews and online surveys and synthesize and analysed data using Microsoft Excel software.

The research results will be a valuable reference for businesses in the F&B industry, including online businesses. In practical terms, this study can be seen as a

scientific basis to support suggestions to solve challenges in the process of using KOLs in marketing for F&B businesses. Thus, this research topic will be a practical document for F&B businesses, helping them see more clearly the advantages and disadvantages of marketing by KOLs, simultaneously determining factors of KOLs and influence levels of each factor on consumers' purchase intentions. Based on that, businesses can promptly adjust and improve service quality as well as business strategies.

## 2 Objective

This thesis aims to analyse the influence of KOLs on consumers' purchasing intentions in Vietnam and thereby to suggest recommendations to Food & Beverage businesses in Vietnam in utilizing KOLs for influencer marketing campaign to help them reach the right target markets and customer segment. In order to accomplish this, we need to obtain knowledge about behaviours and attitudes of consumers, technology accessibility, purchasing experiences, and how they evaluate products via key opinion leaders (KOLs).

An overview of the consumption situation following KOLs and consumers' purchasing decisions in Vietnam will be provided. The influence of KOLs on consumers' consumption decisions will be investigated and dependencies on selected sociodemographic variables of respondents will be tested.

To fulfil those objectives, there are 2 research questions that are needed to be answered:

- How are Vietnamese consumers influenced by KOLs when shopping for beverages and food?
- What are the key factors of KOLs that influence Vietnamese consumers' purchase intention in the F&B industry?

## 3 Literature review

### 3.1 Consumer behaviour

According to Solomon (2017), Consumer Behaviour is a process. "It is the study of the processes involved when individuals or groups select, purchase, use, or dispose of products, services, ideas, or experiences to satisfy needs and desires." (Solomon, 2017, p. 28).

#### 3.1.1 Consumer purchasing decision-making process

People simply believe that making a purchasing decision is just a snap decision in a minute of the consumer, but it is actually a whole process influenced by internal and external factors. According to Kotler and Keller (2012), the consumer generally make their decisions through five stages: problem recognition, information search, evaluation of alternatives, purchase decision, and post-purchase behaviour.

##### 1. Problem recognition

The initial stage in the decision-making process is to recognize the problem or the need triggered by internal and external stimuli (Kotler and Keller, 2012).

Internal stimuli are, among others, a person's basic needs such as hunger, thirst, sex, etc. Those that occur immediately and could be fundamental impulses. When people feel hungry, they will have a need to find food, just as when they feel thirsty, they will have a need to drink. Needs can also be largely aroused when the person is influenced by external stimuli. Advertisements or other people's needs will inspire a person to create a need of them. When consumers realize an unfulfilled need and believe that a product will meet it, they will create a want (Stankevich, 2017).

##### 2. Information search

After the need is recognized, the process may proceed to the second stage of information search.

Kotler and Keller (2012) pointed out that the majority of consumer information sources fall into four groups:

- Personal: reference the experiences of family, friends, neighbours, acquaintances, etc.
- Commercial: information on advertising, websites, salespeople, dealers, packaging, displays.
- Public: others' review on mass media, consumer-rating organizations.
- Experimental: consumer's experience, memory of products or services.

Each source influences the buying decision in different ways. While personal sources provide a legitimizing or evaluation function, commercial sources typically give an informational one. Even though commercial sources provide consumers with the majority of information on a product, the most useful in-

formation frequently originates from public, personal, or experimental sources (Kotler and Keller, 2012).

### 3. Evaluation of alternatives

At this stage, the consumer will consider other alternatives, evaluate them, and decide which of the options he choose is the correct and satisfying choice. To put it more simply, consumers will compare products that are similar but have different attributes and choose to buy a product with the attributes that satisfy them the most.

According to Kotler and Keller (2012), the consumer evaluation process will begin with consumers aim to satisfy their needs, followed by finding certain benefits from the product, and finally looking for the attribute sets of the product that bring the most benefits to consumers (Kotler and Keller, 2012). Stankevich (2017) suggests that those attributes could be price, quality, brand, product positioning, a place where to buy, consequences of using the product, etc. However, the attributes that matter to consumers will differ based on the product (Kotler and Keller, 2012). For example, when a consumer decides to buy a car, the attributes that the consumer cares about will be brand, price, durability, or colour. Unlike when deciding to buy a food item, consumers may care about the quality of the food, food hygiene and safety, its origin, taste and sometimes interested in the price. Based on those attributes, consumers will choose for themselves the product that satisfies their needs and brings the most benefits to them.

"The process on this stage is individual for a consumer as he/she is looking for the best deal." (Stankevich, 2017, p. 11)

### 4. Purchase decisions

This stage can be said to be the most important stage in the purchasing decision-making process.

At this stage, consumers form purchase intentions after evaluating alternatives and then make a decision that leads to the final purchase. However, consumers' purchasing decisions may change at the last minute because of intervening factors. Kotler and Keller (2012) conclude that there are two general intervening factors may intervene between the purchase intention and the purchase decision. *Attitudes of others* is the first factor that intervene consumers' purchasing decisions. The more intense the negative attitudes of people closer to us, the more likely we will change our purchasing decisions and vice versa. The second factor is *unanticipated situational factors* can be considered as the product being out of stock or the payment method not suitable for the user, etc. (Kotler and Keller, 2012)

### 5. Post-purchase behaviour

To put it simply, the final stage of this process produces two different outcomes from the consumer: *satisfied* or *disappointed*.

The greater the gap between expectations and product performance, the higher the dissatisfaction. If the product's performance meets or exceeds expectations, the consumer is satisfied. If the product does not perform as expected, consumers will be more disappointed. Whenever consumers are satisfied, they may buy the product again or recommend it to others. Disappointed consumers will not continue to buy the product again or will even return it back (Kotler and Keller, 2012).

Nevertheless, not all consumers perform all five stages of the buying decision process, they might skip or reverse some stages. When consumers buy their usual brand of product, they might skip the stage of information searching and alternative evaluation and then go straight to the stage of purchase decision (Kotler and Keller, 2012).

### 3.1.2 Factors influencing consumer behaviour

There are many factors that influence consumer behaviour that we cannot fully define. Numerous sources provide various definitions and classifications of these factors in several ways. Recent studies outlined by Tanner and Raymond (2012) suggest that there are four basic factors: *Personal, Psychological, Social and Situational* factors. Furthermore, Kotler and Keller (2012) believes that *Cultural* factors also has an influence on consumer behaviour. These factors are also important factors for marketers to identify their customer segments.

#### 1. Personal factors

Each consumer's personal factors are different. Gender, age, occupation, income, education level, etc. are factors that directly influence consumer behaviour. A woman will buy different products than a man, a young person will have different needs from an elderly person, a person with a high income will have higher purchasing conditions than a person with a lower income.

In addition to those demographic factors, personality and lifestyle also greatly influence consumer behaviour. Kotler and Keller (2012) asserted that people from the same subculture, social class, and occupation can lead quite different lifestyles (Kotler and Keller, 2012). Therefore, the different of these factors will obviously lead to different consumer behaviours.

#### 2. Psychological factors

Consumer behaviour is significantly influenced by psychological factors. These factors explore the mental and emotional aspects that influence people's decisions to make certain purchases. Here are some significant psychological elements that influence consumer behaviour:

##### 2.1. Motivation

Motivation plays a crucial role in shaping the decision-making process. Ramya and Ali (2016) defined motivation as a driving force that impels consumers to take action to satisfy their needs. Therefore, it becomes one of the internal factors influencing consumer behaviour.

Each consumer will have different purchasing motivations. Based on Maslow's hierarchy of needs, consumers will tend to fulfil their basic needs before satisfying higher-level of needs. McLeod (2007) stated that the most basic need of us is for physical survival, and this will be the first thing that motivates our behaviour. Once that level is fulfilled, the next level up is what motivates us, and so on.

## 2.2. Attitudes

Attitude is a psychological factor that significantly influences consumer behaviour. According to Tanner and Raymond (2012), attitudes are “mental positions” or emotional feelings people have about products, services, companies, ideas, issues, or institutions. It is challenging to alter consumer attitudes since it based on their values and beliefs.

Attitude is also a general and lasting evaluation of a person, object, advertisement or issue (Solomon, 2017). Solomon (2017) highlights three components that create a consumer's attitude:

- Affect: Involve emotions and feelings related to the product or brand, describes a consumer's feelings about an attitude object.
- Behaviour: Refers to the actions of consumer a consumer's intention to act in a certain way regarding a product or brand. It reflects the possibility that a customer may buy, suggest, or steer clear of a specific product.
- Cognition: Related to beliefs and knowledge of consumer about a product or brand.

Attitudes help consumers determine their choices and decisions. Consumers mostly reject information that contradicts their attitudes. When consumers experience conflicting attitudes or beliefs, it can lead to cognitive dissonance. Positive experiences, word-of-mouth, and effective marketing campaigns can contribute to the formation of positive attitudes. Therefore, marketers try to alter consumer attitudes, turning negative feelings about the product into positive feelings by providing additional information about the product or through advertising campaigns, marketing strategies on platforms and real consumer experiences, or we can also call it is experiences of Key Opinion Leader (KOL) on social media platforms. This will be discussed more clearly below in this study.

## 2.3. Perception

Tanner and Raymond (2012) defined perception as how you interpret the world around you and make sense of it in your brain through stimuli that affect your 5 senses.

Consumers' perceptions about a brand or product have a significant impact on what they decide to purchase. Marketing's role is to draw customers' attention to their products whether or not they are needed. This can be done through perception. Human perception operates in a very complex way. In psychology, there are two concepts that are useful to this

field. Firstly, it is the *selective perception*, a state when people tend to pay more attention to the information that they need, filtering out irrelevant information. Following to that is *selective retention*, when people tend to remember better what is considered consistent with their beliefs, even forget information that is relevant to them (Tanner and Raymond, 2012).

### 3. Cultural factors

Kotler and Keller (2012) argue that culture, subculture, and social class are particularly important influences on consumer buying behaviour. Culture is the primary factor that determines a person's wants and behaviour (Kotler and Keller, 2012). Culture is what builds up a human community, its individuals, and social organizations. People are members of their social groups and culture, and as a result, their sociocultural environment has conditioned them to act in specific ways (de Mooij, 2010). Solomon (2017) noted that consumers are more likely to embrace products and services that resonate with a culture's priorities at any given time.

Frequently, there are subcultures with specific values and behaviours within a larger culture. Each culture consists of smaller subcultures that provide more specific identification and socialization for their members which include nationalities, religions, racial groups, and geographic regions (Kotler and Keller, 2012). The cultural values consumers were raised with have an important influence on their preferences, attitudes, and decision-making.

In addition, social class is also an equally important factor influencing consumer behaviour. Social class is the division of society into groups with similar levels of wealth, income, education, occupation, and social influence. According to Kotler and Keller (2012) consumers of different social classes have distinct preferences in products and brands in a variety of categories, including clothing, home furnishings, leisure activities, and automobiles. And vice versa, consumers in the same social class might have the same consuming behaviour.

### 4. Social factors

#### 4.1. Reference groups

According to de Mooij (2010), reference group is a group that serves as a reference point in forming consumer's attitudes and behaviour. Consumer's attitudes and behaviours are directly or indirectly influenced by reference groups. Kotler and Keller (2012) highlighted that groups with a direct influence on consumers are membership groups, which are groups that we belong to. Among these are *primary groups*, the most influential group that consumer interacts informally and frequently including family, neighbours, and coworkers. In addition, consumers are also influenced by secondary groups, which are more formal and require less continuous interaction including religious, professional, and trade-union groups. But consumers are also influenced by groups that they do not belong. (Kotler and Keller, 2012)

#### 4.2. Opinion leaders

Opinion leaders are people who influence the opinions, attitudes, beliefs, motivations, and behaviours of others (Valente and Pumpuang, 2007). They could be celebrities, influencers, experts, or even common people. As Kotler and Keller (2012) define, an opinion leader is the person who provides an advice or information about a specific product or product category. They are often highly confident, socially active, and frequent users of the category (Kotler and Keller, 2012). Solomon (2017) found that normally, opinion leaders are technically competent, so they possess expert power. Therefore, their product knowledge and advice are valued by others and are considered as a valuable source of information.

### 3.2 Food and Beverage market

The concept of Food and Beverage (hereinafter F&B) constitutes a fundamental pillar in the modern human existence, amalgamating two elemental components, "food" and "beverage". Food and Beverage simply defined as any raw, cooked, or processed edible sub-stance purposed for human consumption, including ice, water, spirituous liquors, wine, mixed beverages, beer, soft drinks, soda, and other potables.

However, when delving into the realm of the "F&B market", this concept invariably envelops a myriad of diverse production, service, and business activities. These activities can be delineated correspondingly with the lifecycle of F&B products: production, distribution, and consumption. According to the NACE (Nomenclature of Economic Activities) – the statistical classification of economic activities in Europe (2022), the Food and Beverage sector comprises food and beverage production activities (where food is subdivided into 9 groups and beverages into 7 groups); commercial activities encompass wholesale and retail trade (defined in sections 46.3 and 47.2 of the regulation); and lastly, the consumption activities regulated under section 56 of the regulation (NACE 2022).

Thus, it becomes evident that the F&B industry encapsulates a broad spectrum, ranging from beverages vended at vending machines to instant noodles at convenience stores to elaborate meals served at restaurants, cafes, and beyond. Comprehending and analysing the F&B sector can confer significant competitive advantages upon enterprises operating within this domain, particularly amidst a market characterized by numerous fluctuations and shaped by the internet, e-commerce, and social media. Alongside the factors influencing consumer behaviour, this section also delves into the characteristics of the F&B industry and the Vietnamese F&B market situation.

#### 3.2.1 Characteristics of Food and Beverage industry

The foremost characteristic readily discernible within the F&B industry is its "highly competitive" traits. According to a forecast by Vantage Market Research (2022), by the year 2028, the global scale of the F&B industry could reach a stag-

gering 4.4 trillion USD . Due to an immense scale, there remains no doubt regarding the allure of the F&B sector to investors, thereby intensifying competition further. With myriad players ranging from local small businesses to large multinational conglomerates, the landscape of the F&B industry is in a perpetual state of flux.

However, competition also poses challenges for new entrants. According to Bellini (2016), approximately 60% of newly established restaurants close within their first year of operation, while nearly 80% cease operations before reaching the five-year mark. This imparts pressure upon business owners to continually refine business strategies, enhance products, and adeptly grasp market trends. Consequently, it can be inferred that while competition may be fierce, it serves as a driving force for innovation and quality improvement.

We are currently residing in the golden age of information technology, where the advent of the internet and technology permeates every aspect of our lives. Information is exchanged continuously, traversing unimaginable distances, and reaching every corner of the globe (Aslam et al., 2018). This has contributed to interconnecting every part of the world, resulting in what we commonly refer to as "globalization".

A tangible example of this phenomenon is observed when we see Hollywood stars sipping hot Starbucks coffee during their breaks; simultaneously, a consumer somewhere across the globe is also enjoying a similar cup of Starbucks with hardly any discernible difference in taste. Globalization is vividly demonstrated in the increasingly diversified consumer culinary choices. Thanks to advancements in transportation and trade, ingredients from far-flung corners of the world are now readily accessible. This accessibility allows chefs and food producers to experiment with new flavours and create innovative dishes blending traditional cuisines from various cultural backgrounds (Mak et al., 2012) . Additionally, the rise of multinational corporations such as McDonald's, Coca-Cola, and KFC have introduced significant competition into the market. It can be concluded that globalization has profoundly transformed the food and beverage industry, bringing both benefits and challenges alike (Hanks, 2017).

As discussed above, globalization has been mentioned as a contributing factor to providing consumers with more choices. However, along with this, it also presents some challenges. According to the speech by Trichopoulou (2012), the simplification of diets, a hallmark of the globalization model, leads to diets that are less diverse but high in energy. The speech also addressed a solution to this issue, which is traditional foods, or more broadly, "local products" – another characteristic of F&B industry.

Local products play a significant role in the F&B industry. (Pamukcu et al. (2021) asserted that local food items and products with regional characteristics contribute to the advancement of culinary tourism. Through local products, one can capture the tastes of consumers, reflecting their nutritional needs in that area. This serves as a reference point for adjusting the business strategy of the F&B industry, helping F&B products better adapt to each specific region.

Other characteristics of the F&B industry outlined by (Moyalán 2024) are its adjustment and fluctuation influenced by consumer preferences, technological advancements, and global socio-economic trends. The F&B sector often experiences fluctuations in demand based on seasonal trends, holidays, and special events such as festivals or sports events. Businesses can leverage these opportunities through promotional programs and offering suitable menus. There is a notable trend in the F&B industry known as *"digital transformation and online ordering"* (Moyalán, 2024, 4<sup>th</sup> point).

The data from the report of Ortiz-Ospina (2019) revealed the increase of popularity and user base of social media platforms, especially TikTok, short videos are capturing market attention and becoming a marketing tool for potential F&B products. As social media continues to develop, the new type of content which is food reviewing becomes more popular and pursued by many, especially the younger generation. Food reviewing provides consumers with additional information and advice on places with delicious food and quality food products, facilitating their shopping decisions or restaurant choices. Positive reviews from food reviewers can help restaurants and food businesses attract more customers. Positive reviews on social media can generate free advertising and build trust with consumers. This is a significant trend in the F&B industry and will be the subject of this research.

### **3.2.2 Food and Beverage market in Vietnam**

Since a population of nearly 100 million people in Vietnam as well as young demographic trend (PopulationPyramid, 2022), the inclination towards dining out in major urban areas is on the rise, leading to a robust development of the F&B industry in Vietnam. The F&B market has always been a dynamic and ever-changing industry.

According to report by iPOS (2023), by the end of 2023, the revenue of the F&B industry increased by 11.47%, reaching a total of over 590 trillion VND (23.6 billion USD). Specifically, the dining market contributed 538.5 trillion VND (21.6 billion USD), up by 10.87% compared to 2022. Vietnamese consumers are increasing their spending on dining out by an additional 5–10%. In fact, 14.9% of customers are willing to spend more than 100,000 VND (4 USD) for dinner daily, which is 3.5 times higher than in 2022. Simultaneously, spending on coffee by Vietnamese consumers has also slightly increased, with 59.5% of customers willing to spend more than 41,000 VND on this activity. Among those surveyed, 42.6% choose to go out once or twice a month, 30.4% go out once or twice a week, an increase of nearly 8% compared to 2022, and 6.1% of respondents go out daily.

According to Euromonitor, the value of the F&B market in Vietnam is expected to increase by 10.92% in 2023. After a strong recovery and growth, the industry will continue to develop with a compound annual growth rate of 10.25% from 2023 to 2027, reaching an estimated value of 872.9 trillion VND (34.9 billion USD) by 2027 (iPOS, 2023).

Through the aforementioned data, it is evident that despite facing numerous challenges, the F&B market continues to demonstrate its attractiveness, drawing positive spending from consumers. However, the operational landscape for Viet-

name businesses and entrepreneurs in the F&B sector still presents many issues that need timely changes and solutions to sustain and achieve sustainable growth in the Vietnamese market. One such challenge for businesses is a marketing strategy. Marketing is the most challenging issue for many F&B businesses, with up to 52.1% of entities facing difficulties in marketing to attract new customers, retain loyal customers, or compete with rival brands. Conversely, only 17.3% of businesses believe they have an effective marketing communication strategy (iPOS 2023).

Overall, F&B market is an important part of the economy and has undergone many notable developments. The market's revenue scale shows diversity and potential. However, fierce competition and lack of marketing strategy are still challenges for businesses in the industry.

### **3.3 Social media influencers**

As we can all observe, the advent of social media has dramatically changed the way businesses interact with their customers. Along with that change, Social Media Influencers (hereinafter SMIs) is an effective tool in brand promotion campaigns that we can mention. SMIs are defined as an independent third party endorser who shape audience attitudes through social media (Freberg et al., 2011).

#### **3.3.1 Key Opinion Leader**

In the context of a rapidly growing economic market and a fiercely competitive e-commerce industry, Key Opinion Leaders (hereinafter KOLs) is a form of SMIs that has arisen and become beneficial for building brands and brand reputations.

As previously defined for opinion leaders, KOLs are essentially SMIs. They are often people who own a large number of followers on social media and are widely known. Currently in Vietnam, this term is quite common and widespread. When talking about KOL, people will think of an individual or organization that has influence on specific groups on social media. They refer to influencers with a large following and are considered experts in their field (Glasek, 2023). KOLs can be celebrities, prominent people in an industry, people who are popular on social networks such as content creators, vloggers, or highly influential users on social media platforms like Instagram, YouTube, Facebook, Twitter, or TikTok. Indeed, their influence on the consumer behaviour and purchasing decisions of their followers is huge. As a result, KOLs are commonly utilized in marketing strategies to promote products, services, or brands.

#### **3.3.2 Influence of KOL in F&B consumption**

KOLs in the F&B field will be people with expertise in this field and have a significant influence on the social media due to their extensive expertise in the field and industry they have built. They could be celebrities, culinary experts, top mixologists or bartenders, famous chefs, or even food bloggers. KOL act as a brand ambassador or a representative with the mission of promoting a certain F&B brand or

facility to a wider audience. On the other hand, they also act as a Key Opinion Consumer (detail in 3.3.3), who are influential in influencing the purchasing decisions of others through testing and endorsing the experience and quality of a certain F&B establishment or brand and shares their own experience and opinions objectively.

In the current context of the food and beverage industry in Vietnam, KOLs play an important role in forming the purchasing decisions of consumers in general and their followers in particular. According to Ng et al. (2023), consumers could raise their interest and enthusiasm by KOLs' endorsements of certain restaurants, cuisines, or culinary experiences. Xiong et al. (2021) highlighted that consumer would believe that the relevant product promoted by the KOL that they follow is functional and worth buying. The two basic factors of a KOL are listed below:

1. Trustworthiness of KOLs

As study conducted by Xiong et al. (2021), consumers will be easily convinced of the product's functionality and relative value if KOLs is a trustworthy endorser. Consumers will also consider the product worth buying if they believe the KOL is trustworthy. Therefore, consumers might rely on the credibility of KOLs, whose integrity could help the promotion. When a KOL gives a positive review of a particular food or beverage facility or emphasizes the unique qualities of a certain dish or drink, it can trigger a domino effect, inspiring their followers to discover and interact with those products (Ng et al., 2023).

Through this we can see that the influence of KOLs on the consumption decisions of consumers in general and their followers in particular is very significant. Businesses can take advantage of KOL trustworthiness and consumer trust to build brand reputation, attract and drive consumer engagement and purchase intent to gain loyal customers.

2. Expertise of KOLs

Additionally, Xiong et al. (2021) asserts that the higher the endorser's cognitive expertise, the stronger the consumer's purchase intention. Based on consumer psychology, KOLs with expertise in F&B field will increase their credibility value with followers. Nowadays, health and food safety issues receive a lot of attention from consumers. Especially in Vietnam today, according to Cimigo's report, Vietnamese people are increasingly interested in taking care of their own and their family's health. More than half of survey participants shared that they follow a healthy diet (Cimigo, 2022). Therefore, to ensure safety and health, in particular in the food industry, consumers often seek advice from experts when making purchasing decisions.

This shows that KOLs' expertise plays an important role in influencing consumer behaviour by enhancing trust, providing valuable information, providing expert recommendations, create favourable conditions for consumers' purchasing decision. Reviewing the results of the study, Pérez Cabañero (2023) conclude that KOLs' experiments have a positive influence on perceived opinion leadership (Pérez Cabañero, 2023). Businesses can leverage

KOL expertise to build credibility, increase brand awareness, and drive engagement and sales among their target audiences.

### 3.3.3 Key Opinion Consumer

Key Opinion Consumer (hereinafter KOC) is a concept formed based on the basic activities of KOL. Phan and Nguyen (2023) defined KOCs as ordinary consumers who like to share authentic experiences, feedback, and product reviews on social media platforms, providing subjective assessments based on their consumption experiences. In other words, KOCs are considered as real consumers and give evaluations based on individual experience (Nguyen et al., 2023). To differentiate KOCs and KOLs, according to Glasek (2023), the main difference between the two is the scale of their following and their level of influence. Slightly different from KOLs, KOCs have a smaller number of followers and have less influence over KOLs. KOC may not need expertise, they just stand as consumers to experience the product or service, then make subjective assessments to convince their followers.

Regarding the F&B industry, Vietnamese people call KOC by another name, which is “*Food reviewer*”. Basically, they are the people who experience and give reviews about the food of a restaurant, eatery, any dish, promote local cuisine, etc. in many forms such as recording videos, taking photos, writing reviews, and introducing their own experiences (MISA Cuk Cuk, 2022).

In this study, we will focus only on the term KOL in general, which is people who influence consumer behaviour on social media, includes KOC and influencers since they both have the same basic activities.

### 3.3.4 Type of influencers

Influencers are divided into different categories depending on their number of followers. Based on Sanders's (2024) division, influencers are divided into 5 types listed in the table below:

Tab. 1 Type of influencers

| Type of influencers | Number of followers |
|---------------------|---------------------|
| Mega                | More than 1 million |
| Macro               | 500K to 1 million   |
| Mid-tier            | 50K to 500K         |
| Micro               | 10K to 50K          |
| Nano                | 1K to 10K           |

Source: Rob Sanders, 2024

## 3.4 Influencer marketing

Sammis et al. (2015) defined influencer marketing as the “art and science” of engaging people who have influence online to share brand messaging with their au-

diences in the form of sponsored content. Indeed, people are more likely to trust recommendations from who they admire or follow, which leads to increased trust and interest in promoted products.

### **3.4.1 Word-of-mouth marketing**

In order to create positive spread about a product, service, or brand, Word-of-Mouth (hereinafter WoM) marketing is a marketing strategy that businesses use through word-of-mouth sharing by consumers. According to Brown and Hayes (2008), WoM focuses on getting people to talk about you in a positive way. Therefrom creating a domino effect, spreading positive information about a product or service.

Nowadays, the era of technological development 4.0 along with the explosion of the Internet and social networks has brought significant changes in the field of marketing and advertising. Therefore, WoM marketing is no longer simply using traditional marketing channels such as television, radio, and newspapers, but also focuses on investing in digital marketing channels including online websites, social media, email marketing, and advertising on online platforms, as known as social eWoM (Morton, 2020).

Since then, influencer marketing has arisen, which is considered as a comprehensive and effective marketing strategy for businesses. Basically, influencer marketing operates based on the principle of WoM marketing. It is a modern marketing strategy that businesses use to promote products through the influence of influencers on target customers. Brown and Hayes (2008) asserted that influencers will be listened to and believed because they are influencers. Taking advantage of that, businesses can easily convey their messages to target customers, in addition to increasing brand awareness, enhance sales and create engagement with target customers.

### **3.4.2 Utilizing KOL for influencer marketing in F&B industry**

Facing a context of hyper-competitive market currently in Vietnam, utilizing of KOLs is an indispensable part of marketing strategies in the F&B industry. By leveraging the influence of KOLs with quality content and smart marketing strategies, F&B businesses can create a significant and effective influence in connecting and interacting with customers.

According to Nguyen (2020), in the process of influencer marketing, influencers, referred to in this study as KOLs, are invited to collaborate with businesses to convey the message of businesses to the target market, promote the image and value of businesses in customer awareness, thereby increasing consumer loyalty. Based on the process of utilizing KOLs of REVU Vietnam – a marketing agency and other KOLs Booking agencies, the process to collaborate with KOLs includes 5 main important steps:

1. Identify the target

Businesses need to clearly identify customers' goals and their own marketing strategies to be able to choose the most suitable KOLs and optimize resources to ensure the effectiveness and success of the campaign. To effectively define goals, businesses need to set specific goals such as increasing sales, creating more interaction on social networks or increasing brand awareness.

## 2. Search and evaluate relevant KOLs

Businesses will research and identify KOLs with significant influence and followers in the F&B industry. What they are looking for are KOLs who specialize in food, cooking, nutrition, or lifestyle content and have followers that matches businesses' target market. Businesses can search for KOLs that suit their target through KOL platforms, social media, personal blogs or through suggestions from partners and marketing agencies.

To ensure KOLs have a positive influence on audiences, businesses will evaluate the credibility and authenticity of potential KOLs by reviewing the content they have created, engagement metrics, number of followers, community interaction, field of activity, quality of content on media channels, and transparency between work and private life (CleverGroup, 2023).

## 3. Contact and negotiate with suitable KOLs

After finding KOLs that match businesses' marketing goals, businesses will contact KOLs and negotiate to agree on costs, marketing campaign implementation time and the expectations that businesses want.

Depending on the influence and number of followers, price of each category of KOLs will be different. Normally, the more followers KOLs have, the higher the price will be. In addition, content types and social platforms are also factors that determine the price of KOLs. The price of long videos will be higher than short-videos or photos since creating and producing photos is simpler than making videos. As well as the price of content posted on Instagram will be lower than when posted on Facebook since the number of Facebook users in Vietnam is the highest among social networking platforms (REVU Vietnam, 2024; Statista, 2023). After agreeing on those aforementioned, businesses will sign contracts with KOLs to ensure that all terms and regulations are complied with as committed and provide more assurance about the marketing plan.

## 4. Unify the content and deploy the campaign

Businesses will determine the content and messages that they want to be conveyed to their target customers. Then, together with KOLs, they will agree on the content and method of transmission to consumers (REVU Vietnam, 2021). KOLs will be the ones who make and create content that can highlight the message which business wants to convey to their target customers as well as the benefits of consuming their product. Businesses need to rely on the original goal to create informational content suitable for the business's target consumers. Moreover, businesses can optimize the effectiveness of this strategy

by providing KOLs with samples of the business's products or free services at business premises to make content creation more authentic and reputable.

#### 5. Evaluate the results of the campaign

To be able to develop and modify more effective and suitable marketing strategy, businesses will evaluate the effectiveness of the campaign through engagement, brand awareness, sales, Return on Investment (ROI) index, etc. This also decides whether the business should cooperate with that KOL again. If the results are highly effective, it proves that the influence of KOLs on businesses' target customers is significant and appropriate. There are plenty of ways to evaluate and measure the engagement with the content such as reach, clicks, conversions, and ROI, etc. However, recent study outlined by Ordioni (2019) suggested that the most popular way is calculate Engagement Rate by Reach (ERR), which show the percentage of people who chose to interact with our content after noticing it, such as shares, likes, comments.

$$ERR = \frac{\text{Total engagements per post}}{\text{Reach per post}} \times 100$$

#### 3.4.3 Influencer marketing for F&B industry in Vietnam

In the context of the rapid development of social networks and online platforms, influencer marketing is becoming an essential component of Vietnam's marketing industry. Obviously, influencer marketing does not limit itself to a single social media platform but diversify across a variety of social media platforms. According to statistics of AnyMind Group (2022), see in Fig. 1, Facebook is the most popular platform in Vietnam for influencer marketing campaigns, with 79.1% of all campaigns conducted on this platform. In addition, many campaigns are also conducted on Instagram, Tik Tok and You Tube, showing the market's interest in diversifying platforms but is still not very popular.

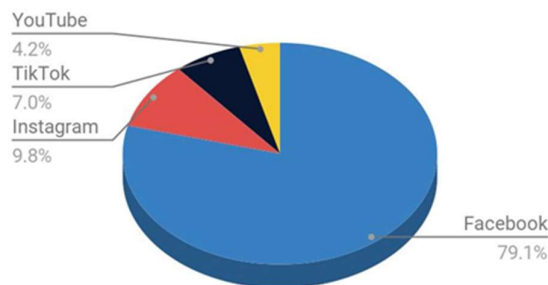


Fig. 1 Popular social networking platform for influencer marketing campaigns in Vietnam.  
Source: AnyMind Group, 2022.

The statistic of AnyMind Group (2022) concluded that Vietnam is one of the countries with the most active F&B industry in the Asian market (see in Fig 2). In Vietnam, F&B industry is in the top 3 industries investing the most in influencer

marketing, ranked 2<sup>nd</sup>, just behind the Family & Education industry. This demonstrates that a significant number of F&B businesses have invested in conducting this marketing strategy.

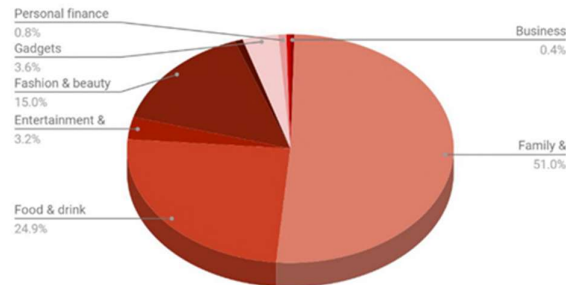


Fig. 2 Industry groups investing the most in influencer marketing in Vietnam.  
Source: AnyMind Group, 2022.

#### 3.4.4 Types of content

Vietnamese social networks have a massive and high-engaged user community. As a result, KOLs must generate diverse content to satisfy high customer demand. Based on numerous sites and advertising agencies currently in Vietnam (REVV Vietnam, 2024; Novaon Comm, 2022), the F&B content that KOLs deliver to the public is conducted through typical forms such as:

- **Video:** Since food and beverages are visual products, this format is the most commonly used as well as the most effective, usually created as long-video or short-video. Longer videos typically contain more information and details than shorter films. Normally, content creators will create long-videos for content that needs to convey a lot of information such as cooking tutorial videos or vlogs about eating (so-called Mukbang), exploring cuisine, etc. Common content in short-videos will often be content reviewing and evaluating F&B products such as food, drinks, services of a restaurant, etc. In such content, the product will usually be cleverly placed in the video by content creators, which can be called product placement.
- **Photos:** This form is simpler than creating a video. Contents are created in the form of a photo with relevant product information, or it might simply be a picture of KOLs taken with that product.
- **Event check-in:** Posts with content about special events and experiences related to F&B products such as food festivals, beverage exhibitions, or new product tasting sessions, points of sale, etc. KOLs will share information about the event, their impressions, and suggest similar experiences to viewers. This form can also be in the form of videos or photos.

- **Affiliate:** In this form, KOLs will provide their followers with special offers, discounts, or gifts through codes to buy products or services from F&B businesses. Through this form, businesses can also track and measure the effectiveness of KOLs in promotional campaigns.
- **Livestreams:** KOLs will directly sell businesses' products on their livestreams and consumers will make purchases through KOLs' channels on several social media platforms.

## 4 Method and materials

Both qualitative, and quantitative methods will be used in this research. Secondary data will be statistical data collected through General Statistical Office of Vietnam (gso.gov.vn), Statista and the related scientific articles and papers.

The primary data were collected via in-depth interviews ( $n = 12$ ), and via online questionnaire to survey ( $n = 210$ ) with people in Vietnam, focusing both on city zones and rural areas. Quantitative data were collected from the online survey. Microsoft Excel statistical software is used for analysing data and effectuating the Chi-Square test of independence between certain variables. Author also made use of her own observation of Vietnamese consumer on social media and use content analysis for the acquired data.

There are 2 research questions that are needed to be answered:

- How are Vietnamese consumers influenced by KOLs when shopping for beverages and food?
- What are the key factors of KOLs that influence Vietnamese consumers' purchase intention in the F&B industry?

### 4.1 In-depth interviews

#### 4.1.1 Data collection method

To obtain knowledge about behaviours and attitudes of consumers, technology accessibility, purchasing experiences and product evaluation via KOLs, in-depth interviews were conducted as a qualitative method. According to Creswell (2012), in qualitative research, to record data as the study proceeds, you develop forms, called “protocols”. These forms provide general questions in an effort to get participants to respond and questions on these forms will frequently change and emerge during data collection or interview.

The questions of the interview are recommended to be open-ended and developed in a semi-structured fashion. According to Dang Minh (2021) use of such questions allows individuals to respond openly and share their thoughts about specific phenomena. The questions asked in the interview revolve around the personal views, experiences, opinions, and perspectives of interview participants about products purchasing based on the promotion and product reviews of KOLs on social media. Thereby, the interview participants set criteria to decide their purchase based on decision-making characteristics such as perfectionism, high-quality consciousness; brand consciousness; novelty-apparel consciousness; hedonistic, recreational shopping consciousness; ‘value for money’ shopping consciousness; impulsiveness; confusion from overchoice; and habitual, brand-loyal orientation (Cowart and Goldsmith, 2007).

The interviews were conducted on Zoom application. Each interview was estimated to last about 20 to 30 minutes depending on the interview participant's

level of confidence and comfort. In addition, it was also necessary to ensure that the internet connection is not interrupted during the interview to avoid missing information. Moreover, since language is a major obstacle in communication, to achieve the most comfort for the interview participants, the interviews were conducted entirely in Vietnamese. Before starting the interview, the interviewer asked the interview participant's permission to record the interview so that it could be used to translate into English and analyse the answers for research purposes.

#### **4.1.2 Sampling**

According to Creswell (2012), the research term used for qualitative sampling is purposeful sampling. In purposeful sampling, researchers intentionally select individuals and sites to learn or understand the central phenomenon (Creswell, 2012).

The in-depth interviews were conducted with 12 Vietnamese consumers in February 2024. Regarding to the gender, according to the statistic of Statista in January 2023, there were 50.6% social media users in Vietnam females and 49.4% were males. Therefore, out of 12 interviewers, 6 were females and 6 were males. Regarding to group of ages, according to the data in 2022 by OOSGA, the 3 age groups with the largest number of social media user are age groups 18 to 24, 25 to 34 and 34 to 44. Consequently, from each age group there were 2 males and 2 females selected. Regarding the area where people live, according to the General Statistic of Vietnam, press release preliminary results the 2019 population and housing census show that people living in urban areas accounted for 34.4% of the population and the remaining 65.6% were people living in rural areas. Therefore, author randomly selected 5 out of 12 interviewees from urban areas and the remaining 7 interviewees were from rural areas.

Summary of interviewees' characteristics:

- Gender: Male [M], Female [F]
- Age group: 18-24 [A1], 25-34 [A2], 35-44 [A3]
- Living area: Urban [U], Rural [R]
- Family status: Single [S], Married [M], Married with children [Mwc]

Tab. 2 Interviewees' characteristics

| Number of interviewees | Gender | Age | Living area | Family status |
|------------------------|--------|-----|-------------|---------------|
| 1                      | F      | A2  | U           | S             |
| 2                      | M      | A1  | U           | S             |
| 3                      | F      | A3  | R           | S             |
| 4                      | M      | A3  | R           | Mwc           |
| 5                      | F      | A1  | R           | S             |
| 6                      | M      | A1  | U           | S             |
| 7                      | M      | A2  | R           | M             |
| 8                      | F      | A2  | U           | S             |
| 9                      | F      | A1  | R           | S             |
| 10                     | F      | A3  | R           | Mwc           |
| 11                     | M      | A2  | U           | M             |
| 12                     | M      | A3  | R           | Mwc           |

Source: author

#### 4.1.3 Interview guide

To get the highest quality results possible, when interview starts, the interviewer needs to establish rapport, and gain the confidence of the interview participants (Creswell, 2012).

In order to “break the ice”, the interviewer can start the interview with questions about self-introduction to make the interview process more natural and comfortable. Then interviewer can start with questions that are easy to answer and not too focused on expertise such as:

- How often do interviewees cook at home?
- How often do they eat or buy food and beverage out-of-home?
- How often do they use social networks?
- How often do they buy food and beverage online?
- Which social network or e-commerce platform do they usually shop on?

Next, the interviewer can begin to dig into more specific questions related to their consumption behaviour and how their influence by KOLs such as:

- Have they ever heard the term “KOL”? Do they know what does the term means?
- Which KOLs do they follow and which social media platform that they usually follow them?
- What are their opinions about products or brands that are marketed by KOLs?
- Have they ever changed their decision because of KOL's opinion?

- What motivates them to use KOL's recommendations for their shopping/choice of restaurants?
- What discourages them to use KOL's recommendations for their shopping/choice of restaurants?
- What factors of KOL influence their purchasing intention? How does it influence you? Which factors is a key factor?

The interviews were semi-structured. Questions were developed based on their previous answers and the interviewer needed to focus on consumer behaviour factors to expand and develop the next question.

## **4.2 Online questionnaire survey**

### **4.2.1 Data collection method**

The online survey as a quantitative method was conducted and distributed on groups on Facebook, Zalo, and Messenger. According to Regmi et al. (2016), data collection through an online survey appears to have the potential to collect large amounts of data efficiently. Therefore, in order to obtain more objective results and ensure to have sufficient number of valid responses ( $n = 200+$ ), the survey was planned to reach nearly 500 social media users in Vietnam since there are people who may give a cursory response or there are people who receive the questionnaire but ignore it and do not respond.

Additionally, to reach more responses, the Snowball sampling method was used in which the author asks the person receiving the questionnaire to share it further with their friends or circle of acquaintances. The survey was conducted in Vietnamese and started from 1<sup>st</sup> of February to 15<sup>th</sup> February 2024.

### **4.2.2 Questionnaire generation**

In order to ensure the achievement of online surveys, the questionnaire must consider the following methodological components such as user-friendly design and layout, selecting survey participants, avoiding multiple responses, data management, ethical issues and piloting tools (Regmi et al., 2016). As a result, the questionnaire conducted on Google Form had 25 questions including sociodemographic questions of the respondents, closed questions, opened questions and questions with Likert scales where respondents mark their level of agreement with given statements.

After completing the in-depth interview process, interviewees brought up several factors of KOL that influenced their purchasing intention. Thereby, the author has concluded 8 main factors which were mentioned by most interviewee and generated them in the online questionnaire survey as the form of a Likert scale to collect data widespread. Each question is evaluated on a Likert scale from 1 (absolutely no influence) to 5 (extremely influence). After assessing the respondent's

answers, the level of influence of those factors on consumers' purchase intention is determined. The questions are listed below:

Tab. 3 5 scale Likert question to measure the level of influence of KOL's factors on consumers' purchase intention.

| <b>How important are these following factors to you and their level of influence on your purchase intention? How much you find these sources as inspirational to you?</b> |   |   |   |   |   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
|                                                                                                                                                                           | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| Reputation of the KOL                                                                                                                                                     |   |   |   |   |   |
| Popularity of a KOL                                                                                                                                                       |   |   |   |   |   |
| KOLs expertise in the F&B field                                                                                                                                           |   |   |   |   |   |
| Highly authentic content of KOLs                                                                                                                                          |   |   |   |   |   |
| KOL's appearance                                                                                                                                                          |   |   |   |   |   |
| Comments or reaction of KOL followers                                                                                                                                     |   |   |   |   |   |
| Your trust in KOLs                                                                                                                                                        |   |   |   |   |   |
| KOLs have a lot of notoriety (their private life scandals)                                                                                                                |   |   |   |   |   |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024

Regmi et al. (2016) believed that online survey approach provides convenience in several kinds. It allows participants to answer questions at their convenient time, take as much time as necessary to complete them, and finish the survey in multiple sessions. Furthermore, online questionnaire surveys are capable of question diversity. Considering these conveniences, sending out online surveys is a reasonable and suitable way to reach larger participants and obtain highly precise answers.

#### 4.2.3 Respondents' sociodemographic characteristics

Two weeks after the survey form was distributed, the author received a total of 210 responses from Vietnamese consumers in all over the nation. After statistics, the result revealed that only 20% of total respondents were working and living in rural areas. In the contrary, up to 80% of total respondents were working and living in city areas. However, this study does not focus on regional factors, so this discrepancy in percentages can be overlooked.

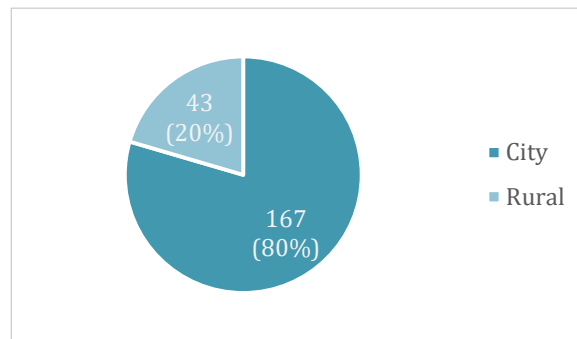


Fig. 3 Share of respondents purchase or experience after seeing KOLs' review.  
Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024.

Summary about demographic characteristic of respondents are listed below (see Tab. 4).

Tab. 4 Respondents' demographic characteristics

| Gender                | Frequency | In % |
|-----------------------|-----------|------|
| Male                  | 85        | 40.5 |
| Female                | 125       | 59.5 |
| Age                   |           |      |
| Under 18              | 7         | 3.3  |
| 18–24                 | 100       | 47.6 |
| 25–34                 | 34        | 16.2 |
| 35–44                 | 32        | 15.2 |
| Above 44              | 37        | 17.6 |
| Education level       |           |      |
| Primary               | 2         | 1    |
| Highschool            | 16        | 7.6  |
| Undergraduate         | 164       | 78.1 |
| Postgraduate          | 28        | 13.3 |
| Family status         |           |      |
| Single                | 124       | 59   |
| Married               | 31        | 14.8 |
| Married with children | 52        | 24.8 |
| Others                | 3         | 1.4  |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210

### 4.3 Observation

Apart from the previously data collection methods, this thesis utilized another qualitative method by using data gathered from the author's observations on social

media. By exploring content on social media, the author can also see how customers interact with KOLs and how KOLs communicate with their audiences, what content is provided and what kind of audience engagement it generates.

#### **4.4 Obstacles and solutions**

The biggest obstacle of this research was geographical distance. Because all survey and data collection processes had to be done remotely, it was more difficult to conduct and more difficult to observe. Surveys and data collection are usually more effective if done face-to-face with participants. However, conducting interviews via video calls also overcomes this obstacle.

The second obstacle was due to the time zone difference. Because the Czech Republic and Vietnam are 6 hours apart, it was difficult to arrange the desired interviews. This was also the reason that limited the length of interviews. However, the author or participants had to arrange interviews during their office hours, which may affect their work and activities.

#### **4.5 Data process**

After being collected, the data from the responses on the Google form was put into Microsoft Excel to perform statistics and testing Chi-Square test of independence. The author also uses Microsoft Excel to create statistical charts and graphs.

## 5 Results

The research focuses entirely on consumers in Vietnam. The analysis results are mainly about consumer behaviour after being influenced by KOLs as well as how KOLs' factors influence consumers' purchasing intentions.

### 5.1 Social media platform preferences for following KOLs

In Fig. 4, the chart illustrates the most used social media platforms to follow KOLs from 210 respondents.

We can see that up to 151 follow KOLs through Facebook and this number accounts for 71.9% of the total respondents. This also reflects reality since Facebook is the leading active social networking platform in Vietnam (Statista, 2023). However, aside from that, TikTok is also interested and used by many respondents, accounting for 58.1% of the total number of respondents. YouTube accounts for nearly half of the total number of respondents with 46.7% while Instagram is not very interested in this area and only accounts for 27.6% of the total number of respondents.

In addition to the four most popular social media platforms, a small number of respondents (5.2%) also mentioned other platforms such as Threads, Telegram, X (formerly Twitter), etc. According to statistics from Statista, although Zalo is the second most active social media platform just after Facebook (Statista, 2023), there is not a single response show that they follow KOLs through Zalo, which indicates KOLs marketing on Zalo are uncommon and rarely used.

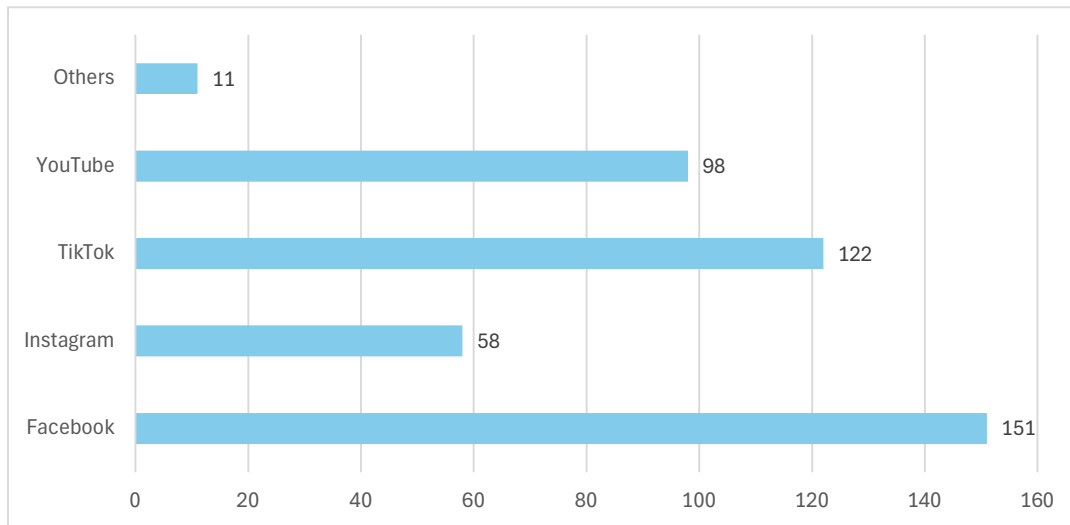


Fig. 4 Social media platform preferences for following KOLs.

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

## 5.2 Consumption situation following KOLs

### 5.2.1 Purchase and experience following KOLs

The pie chart in Fig. 5 reveals the share of respondents who purchase a certain food or beverage product or experience a certain shop or restaurant after being exposed to KOL marketing activities on social media.

From the chart, it is clear that the majority of respondents purchased and experienced products after watching or seeing reviews and recommendations from KOLs, accounting for 81.4% of the total number of respondents. Meanwhile, only 18.6% of total respondents asserted that they never purchased or experienced after accessing KOL marketing activities.

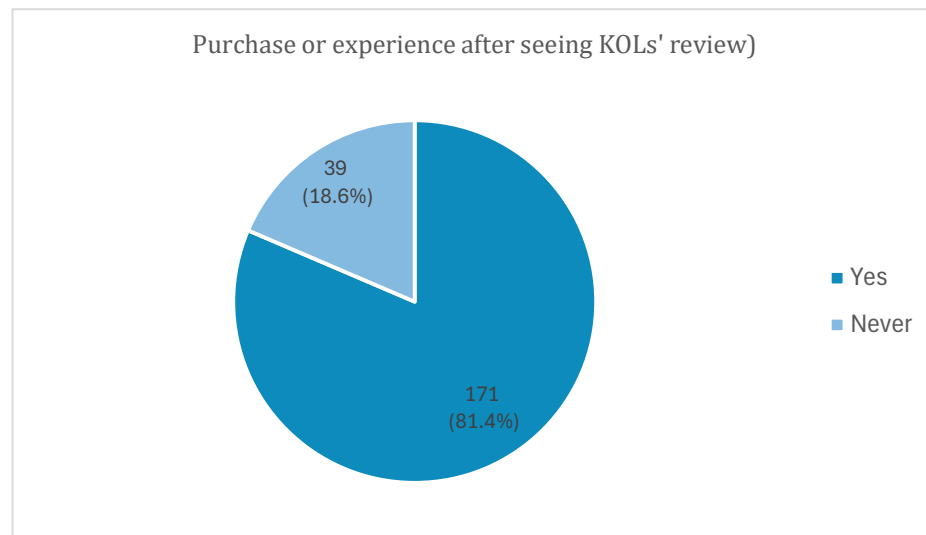


Fig. 5 Share of respondents purchase or experience after seeing KOLs' review.  
Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Statistics showed that 40.5% of respondents were male and 59.5% were female. In order to determine the relationship between purchase or experience following KOLs's review and gender, author effectuated a Chi-Square test of independence between these two variables. The author chooses the significant level of 0.05 ( $\alpha = 0.05$ ), which indicating the probability of incorrectly rejecting the null hypothesis. The null hypothesis and alternative hypothesis are formulated:

- $H_0$ : There is no association between purchase or experience following KOLs's review and gender.
- $H_1$ : There is an association between purchase or experience following KOLs's review and gender.

The results from the test show a p-value of 0.245222 (see Tab. 5), which is greater than  $\alpha = 0.05$ . Subsequently, the null hypothesis is accepted, the alternative hypothesis is rejected, stating that there is no statistically significant association between two variables purchase or experience following KOLs and gender.

Tab. 5 Chi-Square test of independence: Purchase or experience following KOLs x Gender

| <b>Chi-Square (<math>X^2</math>)</b> | <b>df</b> | <b>p-value</b> |
|--------------------------------------|-----------|----------------|
| 1.350322                             | 1         | 0.245222       |

Source: Microsoft Excel, author's calculation

In the survey, respondents have assessed their own likelihood of purchasing and experiencing certain food and beverage product or certain shop or restaurant presented and recommended by KOLs on social media if they are interested in them (see Tab. 6). Only 5.7% of respondents have never purchased or experienced recommended products and establishments no matter they are interested in them or not. Contradictorily, up to 46.8% said that they would likely purchase and experience them if they like them and 20.5% said that they would very likely purchase and experience them if they liked them.

According to statistic values in Tab. 6, the mode and median values of 4 indicate that the most common response and the middle value of the dataset, respectively, were both in favour of purchasing and experiencing certain food and beverage product or certain shop or restaurant presented and recommended by KOLs on social media if they interested in them. With a mean value of 3.71, respondents generally showed a moderate to high inclination towards purchasing and experiencing the recommended products and establishments. Overall, the results demonstrated that respondents have a positive and favourable attitude towards of purchasing and experiencing products and establishments that are endorsed by KOLs on social media in the field of F&B.

In the in-depth interviews, some interviewees said that the recommendation and promotion by KOLs made them feel more curious and interested in the product and establishments as well as feel more assurance due to the endorsement from the KOLs. In addition, KOL's promotional activities give them more ideas and information about the product and establishments they intend to experience. This leads to an escalation in their eagerness to experience and also to verify whether this KOL is trustworthy or not. On the contrary, some interviewees believe that nowadays, most of KOLs are paid by brands to review their products or dining establishments. Therefore, they not only depend on the recommendation of KOLs for making immediate purchasing decisions but also take into account other factors (will be analysed in 5.3) to validate the recommendations provided by KOLs.

Tab. 6 Evaluation of respondents about their probability of experiencing recommended product and establishments.

| Question                                                                                                                                                                                         | 1    | 2  | 3  | 4   | 5  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|----|----|-----|----|
| If you like a certain product (food & beverage) or certain shop/restaurant presented and recommended by KOLs online, what is the probability you would like to try or test the product yourself? | 12   | 15 | 38 | 102 | 43 |
| <b>Mean value</b>                                                                                                                                                                                | 3.71 |    |    |     |    |
| <b>Mode</b>                                                                                                                                                                                      | 4    |    |    |     |    |
| <b>Median</b>                                                                                                                                                                                    | 4    |    |    |     |    |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Never, 5 = Very likely).

### 5.2.2 Consumption following popular trends on social media

The survey allows respondents to rate their consumption level according to popular trends on social media. According to the statistics, only 9% of respondents kept up with all trends that they are approached through KOLs on social media. Apart from that, 18% of respondents said they have never followed any popular trend on social media. Regarding Tab. 7, the mean value of 2.85 presented a moderate level of respondents of desire to experience popular trends on social media. The mode and median values of 3 indicate that the most common response and the middle value of the dataset, which showed respondents moderately inclined towards experiencing popular trends on social media. To conclude, the result suggests a moderate interest among respondents in engaging with popular trends on social media.

In the in-depth interview, some respondents declared that they are not interested in experiencing trends on social media due to their temporary nature. In addition, there are too many shops and business selling identical products, causing them uncertain about the quality. However, other respondents expressed that they want to experience popular trends on social networks because they don't want to miss out on something, we can say it is FOMO (fear-of-missing-out) syndrome. They desire to experience it because other people do. They think that there must be some reason for those trends to become popular and receive a lot of attention. That's why they want to experience it for themselves.

Tab. 7 Evaluation of respondents about their consumption level following popular trends on social media

| Question                                                           | 1    | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------|----|----|----|----|
| How much do you want to experience popular trends on social media? | 38   | 42 | 63 | 48 | 19 |
| <b>Mean value</b>                                                  | 2.85 |    |    |    |    |
| <b>Mode</b>                                                        | 3    |    |    |    |    |
| <b>Median</b>                                                      | 3    |    |    |    |    |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Never, 5 = Keep up with all trends).

Related to the analysing of answers from interviewees in the in-depth interviews, the results found that a number of people in the age group from 18 to 24 and the age group from 25 to 34 expressed their interest and excitement in popular trends on social networks. In contrast, only 1 out of 4 people in the age group from 35 to 44 say they are interested in popular trends on social media. This leads to the assumption that there is an association between this variable and age. Therefore, a Chi-Square test of independence between these two variables is conducted. The author chose the significant level of 0.05 ( $\alpha = 0.05$ ), which indicating the probability of incorrectly rejecting the null hypothesis. Based on the above assumption, the null hypothesis and alternative hypothesis are formulated:

- $H_0$ : There is no association between consumption following popular trends on social media and age.
- $H_1$ : There is an association between consumption following popular trends on social media and age.

Derived from the analysis process, there is more than 20% of all expected values less than 5 (see Tab. 8), which does not meet the assumption of Chi-Square test (Ugoni and Walker, 1995). Moore (2017) suggested a solution to combine adjacent cells to continue to do the Chi-Square test (Moore, 2017). Since there are only 7 respondents in the age group under 18, which is very small data, this group will be combined with the age group from 18 to 24 by adding response of the age group under 18 to the response of the age group from 18 to 24. The outcome after combine cells reduced the percentage of all expected value less than 5 (see Tab. 9), which met the Chi-Square test's assumption.

Tab. 8 Levels of consumption following popular trends on social media and age – Expected value before combination

|     |          | Consumption following popular trends on social media |       |       |       |       |
|-----|----------|------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
|     |          | 1                                                    | 2     | 3     | 4     | 5     |
| Age | Under 18 | 1.10                                                 | 1.13  | 1.87  | 1.93  | 0.97  |
|     | 18 to 24 | 15.71                                                | 16.19 | 26.67 | 7.62  | 13.81 |
|     | 25 to 34 | 5.34                                                 | 5.50  | 9.07  | 9.39  | 4.70  |
|     | 35 to 44 | 5.03                                                 | 5.18  | 8.53  | 8.84  | 4.42  |
|     | Above 44 | 5.81                                                 | 5.99  | 9.87  | 10.22 | 5.11  |

Source: Microsoft Excel

Tab. 9 Levels of consumption following popular trends on social media and age – Expected value after combination

|     |          | Consumption following popular trends on social media |       |       |       |       |
|-----|----------|------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
|     |          | 1                                                    | 2     | 3     | 4     | 5     |
| Age | Under 24 | 16.81                                                | 17.32 | 28.53 | 29.55 | 14.78 |
|     | 25 to 34 | 5.34                                                 | 5.50  | 9.07  | 9.39  | 4.70  |
|     | 35 to 44 | 5.03                                                 | 5.18  | 8.53  | 8.84  | 4.42  |
|     | Above 44 | 5.81                                                 | 5.99  | 9.87  | 10.22 | 5.11  |

Source: Microsoft Excel

The results from the Chi-Square test gave a p-value of 0.000082 (see Tab. 10), which is less than  $\alpha = 0.05$ . The analysis rejected null hypothesis, the alternative hypothesis is accepted, stating that there is an association between two variables consumption following popular trends on social media and age.

Tab. 10 Chi-Square test of independence: Consumption following trends on social media x Age

| Chi-Square ( $X^2$ ) | df | p-value  |
|----------------------|----|----------|
| 39.666545            | 12 | 0.000082 |

Source: Microsoft Excel, author's calculation

To clarify the association between consumption following popular trends and age, a frequency table of evaluation of respondents about their level of consumption following popular trends on social media by age group is conducted (see Tab. 11).

With an average value of 3.49, the age group under 24 shows a relatively high level of consumption following popular trend on social media. The age group from 25 to 34 also shows a moderate level of consumption following popular trend on social media with a mean value of 3.06. Contrastingly, the age group from 35 to 44 expressed their desirability level to experience popular trends on social media is below average, indicated by a mean value of 2.75. Furthermore, the age group above 44 shows that they are barely interested in consuming following popular trend on social through a mean value of 2.19. There is up to 40.5% of the total re-

spondents above 44 years old have never consumed following popular trend on social media.

Through this, we can discern that consumption following trend on social media holds great appeal among younger demographics. This insight highlighted the significance of understanding the preferences and behaviours of different age groups in shaping market dynamics and consumer trends.

Tab. 11 Evaluation of respondents about their level of consumption following popular trends on social media by age group

|                 | <b>1</b>  | <b>2</b> | <b>3</b>  | <b>4</b>  | <b>5</b> | <b>Mean value</b> |
|-----------------|-----------|----------|-----------|-----------|----------|-------------------|
| <b>Under 24</b> | 8         | 15       | 23        | <b>39</b> | 22       | 3.49              |
| <b>25 to 34</b> | 4         | 5        | <b>13</b> | 9         | 3        | 3.06              |
| <b>35 to 44</b> | 6         | 7        | <b>11</b> | 5         | 3        | 2.75              |
| <b>Above 44</b> | <b>15</b> | 7        | 9         | 5         | 1        | 2.19              |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Never, 5 = Keep up with all trends).

### 5.3 Factors of KOLs influence consumer's purchase intention

In the survey, respondents provided their evaluations regarding the influence of KOLs' factors on their purchase intention in the field of F&B after being exposed to KOLs' marketing activities. In other words, they will indicate how much these factors inspired them to make a purchase after seeing reviews or recommendations from KOLs.

#### 5.3.1 Trustworthiness of KOLs

Trustworthiness is one of the first factors of KOLs that influences consumers' purchase intentions. According to the survey statistics (see Tab. 12), up to 43.8% of all respondents believe that the trustworthiness of KOLs influences their purchase intentions. At a higher level, 34.8% of total respondents believe the trustworthiness of KOLs influences their purchase intention extremely. On the contrary, only 3.8% of total respondents affirmed that this factor absolutely had no influence on their purchasing intention. As we can see in Tab. 12, on average, respondents perceive KOLs trustworthiness is an important factor influence their purchase intention, as indicated by the mean value slightly above 4. The mode and median values of 4 indicate that the most common response and the middle value of the dataset, which align with a perception of KOLs' trustworthiness as an essential factor regarding consumer's purchase intention.

In the in-depth interview, interviewees are influenced by this factor emphasized that the trustworthiness of KOLs plays a pivotal role in bolstering their trust in the content shared by KOLs on social media. Furthermore, interviewees expressed that a KOL's trustworthiness serves as a validation of their knowledge and authenticity, creating confidence in the information and recommendations that

KOLs provide. Eventually, KOL's trustworthiness is considered as an important factor in inspiring consumers to purchase following KOLs.

Tab. 12 Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's trustworthiness

|                         | <b>1</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>4</b>  | <b>5</b> |
|-------------------------|----------|----------|----------|-----------|----------|
| Trustworthiness of KOLs | 8        | 9        | 28       | <b>92</b> | 73       |
| <b>Mean value</b>       | 4.01     |          |          |           |          |
| <b>Mode</b>             | 4        |          |          |           |          |
| <b>Median</b>           | 4        |          |          |           |          |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Absolutely no influence, 5 = Extremely influence).

### 5.3.2 Popularity of KOLs

Popularity of KOLs is considered as a second factor that influence consumer's purchase intention. In response to the survey statistic (see Tab. 13), there is 13.3% of the total respondents asserted that the popularity of KOLs absolutely had no influence on their purchase intention and only 9.5% of the total respondents believed that the popularity of KOLs has an extreme influence on their purchase intention. Although these two propositions are opposite, the results are not much different. In Tab. 13, the statistic showed the mean value of 3.07, which presented the popularity of KOLs only affects respondents' purchase intention at an average level. The mode and median values of 3 indicate that the most common response and the middle value of the dataset, sequentially, suggesting a view of moderate impact of KOL's popularity on consumer purchase intention. Generally, statistics reveal that this factor does not greatly influence consumer's purchasing intention, it will depend on each person's perception and perspective.

From the opinions of interviewees in in-depth interviews, their purchase intentions are not influence by KOLs' popularity since they are more interested in other factors. For them, popularity does not guarantee high priority in their decisions. They assert that KOLs who are more famous will not make them to believe in their review and recommendations. In opposition, some of interviewees said that the popularity of KOLs greatly influences their purchase intentions since they choose to believe in famous people. They think that if a person is famous, their credibility will be higher, and they will have to be more responsible for their words. That makes them more certain that popularity goes hand in hand with prestige.

Tab. 13 Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's popularity

|                    | 1    | 2  | 3         | 4  | 5  |
|--------------------|------|----|-----------|----|----|
| Popularity of KOLs | 28   | 32 | <b>67</b> | 63 | 20 |
| <b>Mean value</b>  | 3.07 |    |           |    |    |
| <b>Mode</b>        | 3    |    |           |    |    |
| <b>Median</b>      | 3    |    |           |    |    |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Absolutely no influence, 5 = Extremely influence).

### 5.3.3 Expertise of KOLs in F&B field

The next factor to be considered as one of the factors that influences consumers' purchasing intentions is the expertise of KOLs in F&B field. Analytical data from the survey (see Tab. 14) shows that 38.1% of total respondents affirmed that KOLs' expertise in the F&B field is important and influences their purchase intention, 14.3% of total respondents stated that this factor had an extreme influence on their purchase intention. On the contrary, only 9.5% of total respondents said that expertise had no impact on their purchasing intention. The statistic in Tab. 14 displayed the mean value of 3.38, which indicates that on average, respondents perceive the expertise of KOLs had a relatively positive influence on their intention to make a purchase. The mode and median values of 4 suggested that the most common response and the middle value of the dataset both showed a medium to strong influence of this factor to consumer's purchase intention.

In in-depth interviews, interviewees who affirmed that the expertise of KOLs influences their purchase intentions, mention that the expertise from KOLs allows them to receive more information about the products or F&B establishments, as well as making them feel professionalism in the recommendation-giving and reviewing process of KOLs. They also additionally shared that in recent years, they have been more concerned about health issues, so they pay close attention to their diets and what they consume. KOLs with extensive expertise make them feel more reassured and confident in recommendations of KOLs on social media. Contrary to the former group, those who affirmed that the expertise of KOLs does not play a significant role in influencing their purchase intentions think that the reviews and advice from KOLs ultimately reflect their personal experiences. They believe that a KOL has more personal culinary experiences will provide more practical advice. They also argue that they would trust a person who has lots of culinary experience rather than a professionally trained chef.

Tab. 14 Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's expertise in F&amp;B field

|                                | 1    | 2  | 3  | 4         | 5  |
|--------------------------------|------|----|----|-----------|----|
| Expertise of KOLs in F&B field | 20   | 21 | 59 | <b>80</b> | 30 |
| <b>Mean value</b>              | 3.38 |    |    |           |    |
| <b>Mode</b>                    | 4    |    |    |           |    |
| <b>Median</b>                  | 4    |    |    |           |    |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Absolutely no influence, 5 = Extremely influence).

### 5.3.4 Highly authentic content of KOLs

Obviously, KOLs attract their followers through their content on social media. Therefore, KOL's highly authentic content plays a very important role in influencing consumers' purchase intentions. Based on statistical data (see in Tab. 15), up to 50% of the total respondents declared that highly authentic content positively influences their purchase intention and 23.8% of total respondents declared that this factor had an extreme influence on their purchase intention. On the other hand, only 3.8% of total respondents asserted that highly authentic content of KOLs completely has no influence on their purchase intention. The statistic from Tab. 15 indicated that respondents consider this factor to be quite an influential factor in their purchasing intention with the mean value of 3.84. The mode and median values of 4 suggested that the most common response and the middle value of the dataset both showed a medium to strong influence of this factor to consumer's purchase intention.

Based on the responses from the in-depth interviews, the majority of interviewees believed that content with higher authenticity is more trustworthy. They consider sharing personal viewpoints authentically as providing truthful information, without embellishment or insincere compliment on products and establishments just for advertising incentives. They value speaking the truth, conducting thorough research on products and establishments, providing accurate and heart-felt evaluations, and never promoting low-quality products to consumers just for profit. This reflects their respect for consumer trust and affirms their ethical and moral responsibility when creating and sharing content on social media. This perspective demonstrates that in today's world, where transparency and sincerity are increasingly valued, building credibility and trust is crucial for content creators to succeed in attracting and retaining a loyal fan base.

Tab. 15 Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's highly authentic content

|                                  | 1    | 2  | 3  | 4   | 5  |
|----------------------------------|------|----|----|-----|----|
| Highly authentic content of KOLs | 8    | 12 | 35 | 105 | 50 |
| <b>Mean value</b>                | 3.84 |    |    |     |    |
| <b>Mode</b>                      | 4    |    |    |     |    |
| <b>Median</b>                    | 4    |    |    |     |    |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Absolutely no influence, 5 = Extremely influence).

### 5.3.5 KOLs' appearance

The factor of appearance is also mentioned in influencing consumer purchase intention. According to statistics (see Tab. 16), only 5.7% of respondents believed that appearance of KOLs extremely influences their purchase intention. Meanwhile, 35.2% of respondents believe that this factor has no influence on their purchase intention, and 26.2% of respondents believe that this factor absolutely has no influence on their purchase intention. As the results of data analysis from Tab. 16, the mean value of 2.33 suggested that there is a slightly lower overall influence attributed to the appearance of KOLs. The mode and median values of 3 indicate that the most common response and the middle value of the dataset, which mean that generally, KOLs' appearance has small impact on consumers' purchasing intentions.

In-depth interviews revealed that only a minority of interviewees believed that the appearance KOLs significantly influences their purchase intentions. They stated that when a KOL's appearance is not appealing, they would lose interest in consuming the content shared by that KOL. Conversely, the majority of interviewees asserted that the appearance of KOLs is not a decisive factor since it does not correlate with the trustworthiness of the KOL. They believed that honesty, expertise, and communication skills of the KOL are more important in determining consumer trust. This demonstrates consumers' sensitivity and understanding of the authenticity and quality of the message conveyed by KOLs, rather than solely relying on superficial appearance.

Tab. 16 Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's appearance

|                    | 1    | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  |
|--------------------|------|----|----|----|----|
| Appearance of KOLs | 55   | 74 | 48 | 21 | 12 |
| <b>Mean value</b>  | 2.33 |    |    |    |    |
| <b>Mode</b>        | 2    |    |    |    |    |
| <b>Median</b>      | 2    |    |    |    |    |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Absolutely no influence, 5 = Extremely influence).

### 5.3.6 Interaction of KOL's followers

Another factor that is also mentioned is the interaction of followers with KOLs. Interaction here does not refer to the level of interaction, but rather the communication between followers and KOLs. This interaction is often expressed in comments on posts on KOL channels on social networks. Approximately 30.5% of the respondents affirmed that their purchase intentions are influenced by the comments and reactions of KOL's followers. However, only 11.4% of the respondents stated that this factor absolutely did not influence their purchase intentions. According to Tab. 17, the mode value of 4 indicates that the most common response aligns with a perception of medium to strong influence of this factor. However, with a mean value of 3.34 and a median value of 3, it implies that the overall influence of KOL's followers' interaction on consumer's purchase intention is slightly diminished. Overall, the result of statistic suggested that respondents consider the interaction of KOL's followers to have a significant impact on their purchase intentions.

During in-depth interviews, the author observed that in addition to considering the personal factors of KOLs such as credibility, expertise, and sincerity, the interaction of KOL followers also plays a significant role in assessing the reliability of the conveyed message. They believed that these interactions among KOL followers provide real and multi-dimensional feedback on the products and establishments endorsed by KOLs. Through these interactions, they could assess whether the content shared by KOLs was genuine, relevant to their needs and desires, or merely insincere advertising messages and also helps them gain a more comprehensive and accurate understanding when making purchasing decisions.

Tab. 17 Evaluation of respondents about the influence of interaction of KOL's followers

|                                        | 1    | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  |
|----------------------------------------|------|----|----|----|----|
| Comment or reaction of KOL's followers | 24   | 24 | 58 | 64 | 40 |
| <b>Mean value</b>                      | 3.34 |    |    |    |    |
| <b>Mode</b>                            | 4    |    |    |    |    |
| <b>Median</b>                          | 3    |    |    |    |    |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Absolutely no influence, 5 = Extremely influence).

### 5.3.7 Consumer's fondness for KOLs

One of the important factors influencing consumer's purchase intentions is their fondness for KOLs. According to statistical data (see Tab. 18), a striking 41.4% of total respondents assert that their fondness for KOLs greatly influences their purchase intentions. Conversely, only 2.4% of respondents believe that this factor absolutely does not influence their purchase intentions. As demonstrated in Tab. 18, consumers' fondness for KOLs has a very positive influence on their purchase intention, as evidenced by the high mean value of 4.13 and median of 4. The mode value of 5 indicates that the most common response aligns with a perception of very high influence.

During the in-depth interview process, the majority of interviewees admitted that when they have a fondness for a particular KOL, they tend to trust and place more confidence in that KOL. They perceive the level of friendliness and empathy from the KOL towards them playing a crucial role in establishing a trustworthy relationship. Conversely, when they are not satisfied or do not like a specific KOL, they tend to avoid and are unwilling to purchase or experience products or establishments endorsed by that KOL. This highlights the profound influence of personal preferences for KOLs on consumer's purchase decisions, while also reinforcing the relationship between the emotional connection of KOLs and their followers.

Tab. 18 Evaluation of respondents about the influence of consumer's fondness for KOLs

|                            | 1    | 2 | 3  | 4  | 5  |
|----------------------------|------|---|----|----|----|
| KOL are loved by consumers | 5    | 9 | 26 | 83 | 87 |
| <b>Mean value</b>          | 4.13 |   |    |    |    |
| <b>Mode</b>                | 5    |   |    |    |    |
| <b>Median</b>              | 4    |   |    |    |    |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Absolutely no influence, 5 = Extremely influence).

### 5.3.8 KOLs' private life scandals

Last but not least, the private life scandals of KOLs is also a factor that needs to be considered. There were 22.9% of total responses indicating that the private life scandal of KOLs greatly influences their purchase intentions. Conversely, 21.9% of total responses indicated that this factor entirely does not influence their purchase

intentions. Although these two statements are completely contradictory, they have similar proportions. This indicates a moderate level of influence on purchase intentions for this factor. Furthermore, this is also reflected in the mean value of 3.15 and the median of 3 under Tab. 19. The mode value of 4 revealed that there is a notable impact, it is not overwhelmingly influential. This implies that consumers may take into account private life scandals of KOLs when making purchasing decisions, but it may not be the sole determining factor.

In-depth interviews revealed differing perspectives regarding the impact of private life scandals of KOLs on their credibility. Some interviewees expressed the belief that a KOL with a private life scandal would be deemed untrustworthy, as involvement in scandalous affairs could signify a lack of integrity. However, they also acknowledged that they would consider other factors before completely dismissing the KOL. On the contrary, others held the opinions that the personal life of a KOL has no bearing on their perception and experience. Despite admitting their private life is not impeccable, they asserted that their trust in KOLs remains unchanged, since they have previously found value in KOLs' content.

Tab. 19 Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's private life scandal

|                                                          | <b>1</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>4</b>  | <b>5</b> |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|-----------|----------|
| KOL have lots of notoriety (their private life scandals) | 46       | 21       | 46       | <b>49</b> | 48       |
| <b>Mean value</b>                                        | 3.15     |          |          |           |          |
| <b>Mode</b>                                              | 4        |          |          |           |          |
| <b>Median</b>                                            | 3        |          |          |           |          |

Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210.

Note: Likert scale 1 to 5 (1 = Absolutely no influence, 5 = Extremely influence).

## 6 Recommendations

From the results analysed above, a comprehensive view of the consumption situation following KOLs and the key factors of KOLs influence consumers' purchase intentions has been clarified. Drawing upon these findings, several recommendations are proffered to F&B brand and businesses:

### 6.1 KOL marketing

#### 6.1.1 Utilize suitable social media platforms

It can be observed that **Facebook** and **TikTok** are the two most widely used platforms in Vietnam for accessing KOLs in the field of F&B from the finding in the previous part. These platforms operate strongly in Vietnam, maintain their roles as leading advertising and marketing platforms. They are not only platforms for sharing short-videos but also vibrant and creative communities, attracting a young and dynamic user base. With their concise and engaging approach, these platforms have become powerful tools for KOLs and brands to connect with their audience. The rapid development of TikTok and Facebook in Vietnam has also opened up new opportunities for F&B businesses to reach diverse and potential customer segments.

Therefore, based on the popularity of Facebook and TikTok as the two most popular social media platforms in Vietnam, attracting diverse user demographics, F&B businesses and brands can leverage this information to enhance their marketing strategies. Investing in building relationships with KOLs on Facebook and TikTok can help F&B businesses and brands reach a broader audience, foster positive interactions, and strengthen their credibility in the market.

#### 6.1.2 Choose suitable KOLs

In today's era of advanced technology, online marketing is an indispensable part of businesses. Therefore, KOL marketing is a modern and effective marketing tool for businesses to generate marketing campaigns. Collaborating with KOLs is essential in branding campaigns to build trust and credibility with consumers. Additionally, partnering with KOLs can help businesses enhance their recognition and awareness in the online community. Marketing through KOLs helps businesses effectively reach their target audience since KOLs have a strong influence on a specific group of people. Therefore, choosing a suitable KOL for the business is crucial and significantly impacts the business.

KOLs have a certain and loyal follower community. From the above finding, it can be observed that the **trustworthiness of KOLs** strongly influences consumers' purchasing intentions. Trustworthy KOLs always focus on conveying accurate and impartial messages about the business's products or services, thereby avoiding bias and transmitting misinformation to consumers. Furthermore, they ensure to only collaborate with brands that they genuinely believe in and support. Partner-

ing with them helps to protect the business from risks and negative consequences that may arise from associating with unreliable KOLs. Therefore, businesses need to choose to collaborate with highly trustworthy KOLs to build trust and credibility with consumers.

In the process of searching for KOLs to collaborate in marketing campaigns, businesses should also pay attention to the **popularity of these KOLs**. The results of the above analysis show that the popularity of KOLs also has a fairly positive influence on consumers' purchasing intentions. Therefore, collaborating with highly famous KOLs can increase brand recognition and consumer trust in the business, while also expanding the reach to new customer segments. However, the analysis results indicate that the influence of this factor is only slightly above average, so businesses should also consider when collaborating with highly famous KOLs. Especially for newly established businesses, collaborating with highly famous KOLs may require quite a lot of financial investment. As a solution, these businesses can start by collaborating in advance with less famous KOLs, further researching more the market and evaluating the effect of this marketing tool. Until then, businesses can consider investing in collaborations with highly famous KOLs.

In the field of F&B, businesses should consider collaborating with **KOLs which has expertise in this field**. An KOLs with expertise in F&B possesses extensive knowledge about food, beverages, and culinary trends, enabling them to deeply understand the product and brand message. They could include chefs, mixologists, culinary experts, etc. Their expertise builds trust and credibility with consumers. The finding above highlights the significant influence of KOLs with expertise on consumer's purchase intention. However, this approach also comes with drawbacks that need to be noted. KOLs with expertise may sometimes be conservative in expressing personal opinions and not fully adhere to brand guidelines, resulting in inconsistencies in message delivery. Additionally, as sought-after collaborators, they may face intense competition from multiple brands, leading to fierce rivalry and increased collaboration costs for businesses.

Businesses should also focus on the **interactions of KOL followers** on social media. According to the analysis result, most consumers based on the interactions of KOL followers as a secondary basis to confirm the credibility of the KOL. Therefore, businesses need to choose to collaborate with KOLs who have positive interactions from their followers on social media to avoid brand impact and as a step to reaffirm the credibility of the KOL.

Businesses should be circumspect in collaborating with KOLs that have lots of private life scandal. From the analysis results, it can be seen that **KOLs with lots of private life scandal have a negative influence on consumer purchase intention** as well as image of business. Any negative behaviour by KOLs can reflect negatively on the brand and lead to reputational damage. Therefore, businesses need to carefully consider selecting KOLs with scandals to collaborate in order to avoid risks to the business. Businesses should negotiate a compensation clause in the collaboration contract with KOLs in the case they cause any scandals that affect the business's image.

Furthermore, there are **factors that have minimal influence on consumer purchase intention**, such as the **appearance of the KOL**. Based on the findings above, this factor does not significantly influence consumer purchase intention. As a result, businesses should consider this factor as a low priority in the process of searching for KOLs to collaborate with.

### 6.1.3 Control output of content

The content posted on social media plays a crucial role in connecting businesses with consumers, serving as a vital tool for conveying the messages and information about a business's products and services to consumers. **Investing in content and imagery on social media is extremely important, ensuring that it accurately reflects the essence and values of the business.** From the research findings, the **authenticity** of the content becomes critically important. To achieve this, businesses need to closely collaborate with KOLs to create high-quality content with a high level of authenticity.

It is essential to clearly make agreements with KOLs on criteria and rules when creating content. Businesses should provide for KOLs with all necessary information about the products and services being promoted as well as require KOLs to thoroughly research business's products or services to **avoid conveying inaccurate information**. In addition, businesses could provide samples of their products or services to KOLs to assist in creating more authentic content. Furthermore, businesses should encourage KOLs not to use overly edited images, avoiding raising unrealistic expectations among customers about the product. In recent years, the emergence of short-video content is becoming increasingly popular, so incorporating it into KOL marketing campaigns is a wise strategy. Although it costs more than photo or blog content, short-video can convey messages more effectively, attracting customers' attention without making them feel bored, as is often the case with long-video content.

## 6.2 Following popular trends is potential

In a competitive and dynamic market, following popular trends is considered as an effective business strategy, plays a crucial role in sustaining and developing enterprises. This strategy is considered a flexible, diverse, and opportunistic method for businesses. For new businesses, following trends can open up opportunities to reach a wider market and expand their customer segmentation, as well as increasing brand recognition opportunities. For long-established enterprises, following trends can help businesses to expand their product portfolios also express their flexibility in adapting to the dynamic market. Adopting this strategy allow businesses to gain a deeper understanding of their markets and customers, simultaneously contribute to increased sales and profits.

However, based on the research findings, it can be observed that this strategy tends to be effective primarily for businesses targeting young Vietnamese customers due to their ability to quickly grasp trends. Therefore, businesses need to care-

fully consider before adopting this strategy, especially in cases where businesses' target market are older consumers.

It is important to note that the market is constantly evolving, and consumer behaviour is rather unpredictable. Hence, before implementing any business strategy, enterprises need to carefully evaluate its feasibility, profit potential, and relevance to their industry.

## 7 Discussion

The main objective of this research is to analyse the influence of KOLs on consumer's purchasing intentions in Vietnam and thereby to suggest recommendations to Food & Beverage businesses in Vietnam in utilizing KOLs for influencer marketing campaign to help them reach the right target markets and customer segment. However, to achieve this, this study has many significant limitations. Firstly, the percentage between age groups of survey respondents has a large difference when the 18–24 age group accounts for 47.6%, nearly half of the total number of respondents. This causes the results to be mainly biased towards the consumption intentions of this age group. Simultaneously, the sample size of the study is not large enough to represent all Vietnamese consumers. In addition, this is a fairly new topic in Vietnam, so finding research materials is very difficult. In addition, the language barrier is also a significant limitation in the process of converting Vietnamese respondents' answers to English, which leads to errors in the meaning of vocabulary and content.

Comparing to the previous research conducted in Vietnam on the influence of KOLs on the purchasing intention of Vietnamese consumers, the author found that there were also some similar results with this study. According to the results of (Phan and Nguyen 2023), trustworthiness and expertise of KOL have a positive influence on consumers' purchase intention. Those results are similar to the results of this study that these two factors influence consumers' purchasing intentions with the mean values of 4.01 and 3.38 respectively based on the 5-point Likert scale.

However, there are also some differences between this study and previous research. Nguyen and Phan's results revealed that likeability of KOL (i.e. fondness of KOL in this research) does not influence consumers' purchasing intentions. That result is completely opposite to the result that this study found that this factor strongly influences the purchasing intention of Vietnamese consumers with the mean value of the fondness of KOL factor being 4.13 based on the 5-point Likert scale. Because the consumption habits of Vietnamese people change continuously over time, as well as the increasingly intelligent consumption of Vietnamese people, consumers' awareness of this factor is no longer important to them as it used to be. Alternatively, consumers will focus more on other important KOL factors that influence their purchase intention.

Overall, this research topic compared to previous research still has many limitations. However, this study provides the influence of other factors of KOL that previous research has not provided. Moreover, this study has contributed the latest results of this topic. Therefore, this research article will be a valuable reference for F&B businesses in Vietnam as well as other foreign businesses wanting to penetrate the Vietnamese F&B market.

## 8 Conclusion

The rapid development of technology has brought about significant changes in marketing strategies, contemporaneous the emergence of KOLs has become an integral part of the marketing strategies of many businesses. This thesis focuses on analysing the influence of KOLs on the purchase intention of Vietnamese consumers in the F&B field. To achieve the objectives of the thesis, in-depth interviews were conducted with 12 Vietnamese consumers, and an online survey with 210 respondents was carried out to collect data for the research. Based on the results from the qualitative data obtained from the in-depth interviews, the discovery was made regarding how KOLs influence the purchase intention of consumers and simultaneously identified the general consumption patterns of Vietnamese consumers following KOLs. From results of the in-depth interviews, all of interviewees revealed that KOLs have quite a positive influence on consumers' purchase intentions through different factors. This contributed to the answer of the first research question of the thesis.

From the findings of this study, the popularity of KOLs strongly influences the purchase intentions of Vietnamese consumers. According to the in-depth interview, consumers indicate that the greater the popularity of KOLs, the higher their perceived trustworthiness since they must uphold their credibility to sustain their popularity.

Furthermore, consumers' fondness for KOLs significantly influence consumers' purchase intentions. According to the results, consumers will trust their favourite KOLs more than the one they do not like.

According to in-depth interview, consumers see the content that KOLs transmit on social networks as a useful tool in saving time searching for information about products and dining establishments. Therefore, a KOL with expertise in this field has an advantage in providing recommendations and evaluation to consumers. This also makes KOLs more trustworthy in the eyes of consumers. In addition, the content that KOLs transmit on social networks needs to be highly authentic because according to research results, the authenticity of the content that KOLs post has a strong influence on consumers' purchasing intentions.

As for businesses, the content of KOLs on social networks is an extremely important communication tool with consumers. The survey results also revealed that the authenticity of the content posted by KOLs has a strong influence on consumers' purchasing intentions. Therefore, conveying highly authentic content plays a very important role in delivering the brand's message and creating trust with customers.

Additionally, a KOL's community of followers on social media plays an important role in establishing consumer trust in the KOL. Many consumers from interviews said they often rely on the reactions and comments of KOL's followers to implicitly determine whether the content KOLs convey is correct or not. Therefore, the interactions of KOL's followers on social media are an important tool of KOL to build their trustworthiness.

Consumers often lose trust in KOLs who have scandals in their private lives. From the results of in-depth interviews, consumers revealed that these KOLs are not trusted since they discovered that KOL's bad personalities through their private life scandals. From there we can see that this factor has a negative influence on consumers' purchase intention.

KOL's appearance does not play an important role in influencing consumers' purchase intentions, as indicated by research results. Due to changing human perceptions and the promotion of social equality over the past decade, people have become less biased by appearance and are focusing more on personality values.

Quantitative data and qualitative from the online survey were both conducted and analysed to understand the consumer behaviour of Vietnamese consumers as well as analysed the important factors of KOLs influencing the purchase intention of Vietnamese consumers in the F&B field. From the analysis of these factors, it can be observed that all of the factors that influence on the purchase intention serve as the foundation for the trustworthiness of the KOLs. Therefore, this factor is considered as a key factor in evaluating KOLs for utilizing in marketing campaigns and influence consumers' purchase intention. These findings hold significant implications for addressing the second research question of the thesis.

As a consequence, broadly translated our findings indicate that KOLs wield significant influence on the consumption behaviour of Vietnamese consumers when shopping for foods and beverages. Utilizing KOL marketing is a modern tool that yields positive effects for F&B businesses in reaching consumers and promoting brands. Therefore, businesses need to harness the potential of this marketing tool to optimize marketing campaigns and promote closer connections between businesses and consumers. The practical recommendations provided in this research are based on the insights gathered from in-depth interviews and complemented by analysis and validation from data collected through online surveys. Additionally, the author's personal observations from her own behaviour consumption behaviour while shopping for foods and beverages contribute to these insightful recommendations. Businesses can rely on this research to gain a deeper understanding of KOL marketing and Vietnamese consumer behaviour, ensuring that marketing strategies are well-designed and effective, and making informed decisions to improve business outcomes and achieve the best results in F&B business operations.

In addition to the significant findings of this study, it must be acknowledged that this research also has several limitations, such as language translation issues and a sample size that may not adequately represent all consumers in Vietnam. These limitations provide a good starting point for discussion and further research. Future studies should aim to replicate the results with a larger sample size and utilize more effective, meaningful, and accurate tools due to the limitations of the current study.

## 9 References

- ANYMIND GROUP, 2022. *State of Influence in Asia 22/23*. Online. Available from: <https://anymindgroup.com/vi/report/im-2223-report>
- ASLAM, Aqib, EUGSTER, Johannes, HO, Giang, JAUMOTTE, Florence and PIAZZA, Roberto, 2018. Globalization Helps Spread Knowledge and Technology Across Borders. *IMF BLOG*. Online. 9 April 2018. Available from: <https://www.imf.org/en/Blogs/Articles/2018/04/09/globalization-helps-spread-knowledge-and-technology-across-borders>
- BELLINI, Jarrett, 2016. The No. 1 thing to consider before opening a restaurant. *makeit*. Online. 2016. Available from: <https://www.cnbc.com/2016/01/20/heres-the-real-reason-why-most-restaurants-fail.html>
- BROWN, Duncan and HAYES, Nick, 2008. *Influencer Marketing: Who Really Influences Your Customers?* ELSEVIER. ISBN 978-0-7506-8600-6.
- CIMIGO, 2022. Healthy eating needs and trends in Vietnam. *Cimigo*. Online. 20 December 2022. Available from: <https://www.cimigo.com/vi/trends/nhu-cau-va-xu-huong-an-uong-lanh-manh-viet-nam/>
- CLEVERGROUP, 2023. What is Book KOL? All the information you need to know. . Online. 19 March 2023. Available from: <https://cleverads.vn/blog/book-kol/>
- COWART, Kelly O. and GOLDSMITH, Ronald E., 2007. The influence of consumer decision-making styles on online apparel consumption by college students. *International Journal of Consumer Studies*. 1 November 2007. Vol. 31, no. 6, p. 639–647. DOI 10.1111/j.1470-6431.2007.00615.x.
- CRESWELL, J.W., 2012. *Educational Research: Planning, Conducting, and Evaluating Quantitative and Qualitative Research*. Online. Pearson. ISBN 978-0-13-136739-5. Available from: <https://books.google.cz/books?id=4PywcQAACAAJ>
- DANG, Minh Thu, 2021. *Consumer behavior towards organic food: The case of Vietnam*. Online. Prague: Vysoká škola ekonomická v Praze. Available from: <https://vskp.vse.cz/english/83838>
- DE MOOIJ, Marieke, 2010. *Consumer Behavior and Culture: Consequences for Global Marketing and Advertising*. 2. SAGE. ISBN 1-4522-3623-2.
- FREBERG, Karen, GRAHAM, Kristin, MCGAUGHEY, Karen and FREBERG, Laura A., 2011. Who are the social media influencers? A study of public perceptions of personality. *Public Relations Review*. 2011. Vol. 37, no. 1, p. 90–92. DOI <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pubrev.2010.11.001>.
- GENERAL STATISTIC OF VIETNAM, 2019. PRESS RELEASE PRELIMINARY RESULTS THE 2019 POPULATION AND HOUSING CENSUS. *GENERAL STATISTICS OFFICE*. Online. 2019. Available from: <https://www.gso.gov.vn/en/data-and-statistics/2019/10/press-release-preliminary-results-the-2019-population-and-housing-census/>

- GLASEK, Michael, 2023. KOC vs KOL Differences: A Guide to the world of “influencers.” *LinkedIn*. Online. 16 March 2023. Available from: <https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/koc-vs-kol-differences-guide-world-influencers-michael-glasek-%E7%8E%8B%E6%98%8A%E6%98%8E> [Accessed 15 March 2024].
- HANKS, Gerald, 2017. Globalization of the Food & Beverage Industry. *bizfluent*. 26 September 2017.
- IPOS, 2023. *Food business market report in Vietnam in 2023*. Online. Available from: <https://ipos.vn/bao-cao-nganh-fnb-2023/>
- KIM, Hien, 2016. Many business opportunities in the field of food and restaurant services. *Economy & Forecast Review*. Online. 22 December 2016. Available from: <https://kinhtevadubao.vn/nhieu-co-hoi-kinh-doanh-trong-linh-vuc-am-thuc-va-dich-vu-nha-hang-5817.html>
- KOTLER, Philip and KELLER, Kevin Lane, 2012. *Marketing Management*. Online. 14th. Pearson. ISBN 978-0-13-210292-6. Available from: [https://bawar.net/data0/books/5ba269133886d/pdf/\[Philip\\_Kotler,\\_Kevin\\_Lane\\_Keller\]\\_Marketing\\_Manag.pdf](https://bawar.net/data0/books/5ba269133886d/pdf/[Philip_Kotler,_Kevin_Lane_Keller]_Marketing_Manag.pdf)
- MAK, Athena H. N., LUMBERS, Margaret and EVES, Anita, 2012. Globalisation and food consumption in tourism. *Annals of Tourism Research*. 2012. Vol. 39, no. 1, p. 171–196. DOI <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.annals.2011.05.010>.
- MCLEOD, Saul, 2007. Maslow’s hierarchy of needs. *Simply psychology*. Online. 2007. Vol. 1, no. 1–18. Available from: [https://www.simplypsychology.org/maslow.html?ez\\_vid=2cae626a2fe896279da43d587baa3eb663083817](https://www.simplypsychology.org/maslow.html?ez_vid=2cae626a2fe896279da43d587baa3eb663083817)
- MISA CUK CUK, 2022. Top 10 famous Food Reviewers in Vietnam today. Online. 25 May 2022. Available from: <https://www.cukcuk.vn/14665/food-reviewer/>
- MOORE, Terry, 2017. In chi-square distribution(statistics), why do we assume that the expected value is greater than 5? How significant is this assumption? *Quora*. Online. 2017. Available from: <https://www.quora.com/In-chi-square-distribution-statistics-why-do-we-assume-that-the-expected-value-is-greater-than-5-How-significant-is-this-assumption>
- MORTON, Flor, 2020. Influencer marketing: An exploratory study on the motivations of young adults to follow social media influencers. August 2020. Vol. 8, p. 156–165.
- MOYALAN, Anoop A, 2024. Exploring Current Trends in the Food and Beverage Industry. *LinkedIn*. Online. 29 February 2024. Available from: <https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/exploring-current-trends-food-beverage-industry-anoop-anto-moyalan-0un7c>
- NACE, 2022. Regulation (EC) No 1893/2006 of the European Parliament and of the Council establishing the statistical classification of economic activities NACE Re-

- vision 2. Online. 10 October 2022. Available from: <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/HTML/?uri=CELEX:32023R0137#d1e148-5-1>
- NG, Wei Chien, ONG, Yong Wang, OAN, Kien Boon, OOI, Cheah Ting, OOI, Joanne, HABIBIE, Muhammad Fadhlán, CHOUDHARY, Tanu, RAGHAV, Utkarsh and KEE, Daisy Mui Hung, 2023. The Impact of Social Media and Key Opinion Leader on the Purchasing Behaviour in the Food and Beverage Industry in Malaysia. *Journal of The Community Development in Asia*. 2023. Vol. 6, no. 3, p. 17–31.
- NGUYEN, Minh, NGO, Trieu, LE, Hong and HOANG, Thu-Hang, 2023. KOCs characteristics, KOC effectiveness and online customer engagement towards travel products: evidence from Vietnam. *International Journal of Internet Marketing and Advertising*. January 2023. Vol. 1, p. 1. DOI 10.1504/IJIMA.2023.10056135.
- NGUYEN, My, 2020. *The Impact of Influencer Marketing in Vietnamese Customers' Perceptions*.
- NOVAON COMM, 2022. Processing “Influencers menu” for the F&B industry to bring prosperity in the beginning of the new year 2022. *Advertising Vietnam*. Online. 23 February 2022. Available from: <https://advertisingvietnam.com/che-bien-menu-influencers-cho-nganh-fb-thu-loc-phat-tai-dau-xuan-nam-moi-2022-p18950>
- OOSGA, 2023. Social Media in Vietnam - 2023 Stats & Platform Trends. *OOSGA*. Online. 30 October 2023. Available from: <https://oosga.com/social-media/vnm/>
- ORDIONI, Jody, 2019. How to Calculate Your Social Media Engagement Rate. *ERE*. Online. 17 September 2019. Available from: <https://www.ere.net/articles/how-to-calculate-your-social-media-engagement-rate>
- ORTIZ-OSPINA, Esteban, 2019. The rise of social media. *Our World in Data*. 2019.
- PAMUKCU, Huseyin, SARAC, Omer, AYTUGAR, Sercan and SANDICKI, Mustafa, 2021. The Effects of Local Food and Local Products with Geographical Indication on the Development of Tourism Gastronomy. Online. 6 December 2021. DOI <https://doi.org/10.3390/su13126692>.
- PÉREZ CABAÑERO, Carmen, VEAS GONZÁLEZ, Ivan, NAVARRO CISTERNAS, Carolina, ZULETA CORTÉS, Hugo and URIZAR URIZAR, Camila, 2023. Influencers who most engage on Instagram. The effect of their expertise, taste leadership and opinion leadership on their followers' behavioural intentions. 2023.
- PHAN, Ngoc Thuy Trang and NGUYEN, Tan Minh, 2023. The Influence of Key Opinion Consumers on Customers' Purchase Intention via TikTok-The Case of Generation Z in Vietnam. *Review of Integrative Business and Economics Research*. 2023. Vol. 13, no. 1, p. 51–70.
- POPULATIONPYRAMID, 2022. *Population Pyramids of Vietnam 2022*. Online. 2022. Available from: <https://www.populationpyramid.net/viet-nam/2022/>
- RAMYA, Nasam and ALI, S. Mohamed, 2016. Factors affecting consumer buying behavior. *International journal of applied research*. 2016. Vol. 2, no. 10, p. 76–80.

- REGMI, Pramod R., WAITHAKA, Elizabeth, PAUDYAL, Anjana, SIMKHADA, Padam and VAN TEIJLINGEN, Edwin, 2016. Guide to the design and application of online questionnaire surveys. *Nepal journal of epidemiology*. December 2016. Vol. 6, no. 4, p. 640–644. DOI 10.3126/nje.v6i4.17258.
- REVU VIETNAM, 2021. What is Influencer Marketing? Effective Implementation Process 2022. *REVU*. Online. 5 August 2021. Available from: <https://blog.vn.revuu.net/influencer-marketing-la-gi/>
- REVU VIETNAM, 2024a. How to Calculate the Best KOL Rental Price - Price List 2024. *REVU*. Online. 5 March 2024. Available from: [https://blog.vn.revuu.net/thue\\_kol/](https://blog.vn.revuu.net/thue_kol/)
- REVU VIETNAM, 2024b. TikTok KOL Rental Price for Businesses 2024. *REVU*. Online. 15 March 2024. Available from: <https://blog.vn.revuu.net/gia-thue-kol-tiktok/>
- SAMMIS, Kristy, LINCOLN, Cat and POMPONI, Stefania, 2015. *Influencer marketing for dummies*. John Wiley & Sons. ISBN 1-119-11392-X.
- SOLOMON, Michael R., 2017. *Consumer Behavior: Buying, Having, and Being*. 12th. Pearson Education. ISBN 978-0-13-412993-8.
- STANKEVICH, Alina, 2017. Explaining the Consumer Decision-Making Process: Critical Literature Review. Online. 2017. Vol. 2, no. 6. DOI 10.18775/jibrm.1849-8558.2015.26.3001.
- STATISTA, 2023. Social media in Vietnam - statistics & facts. *Statista*. Online. 21 December 2023. Available from: <https://www.statista.com/topics/8182/social-media-in-vietnam/#topicOverview> [Accessed 14 January 2024].
- TANNER, John F. (Jeff) and RAYMOND, Mary Anne, 2012. *Marketing Principles*. Online. Available from: <https://2012books.lardbucket.org/>
- TRICHOPOULOU, Antonia, 2012. Diversity v. globalization: traditional foods at the epicentre. In: *Public Health Nutrition*. Online. Cambridge University Press. p. 951–954. Available from: <https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/public-health-nutrition/article/diversity-v-globalization-traditional-foods-at-the-epicentre/BE8B929098768A7B0FF4E0E563D806EE>
- UGONI, Antony and WALKER, Bruce F., 1995. The Chi square test: an introduction. *COMSIG review*. 1995. Vol. 4, no. 3, p. 61.
- VALENTE, Thomas W. and PUMPUANG, Patchareeya, 2007. Identifying opinion leaders to promote behavior change. *Health education & behavior*. 2007. Vol. 34, no. 6, p. 881–896.
- VANTAGE MARKET RESEARCH, 2022. Global Food Service Market Size to Grow by USD 4431.5 Billion | Revenue Forecast, Company Ranking, Competitive Landscape, Growth Factors, And Trends. *GlobeNewswire*. Online. 24 May 2022. Available from: <https://www.globenewswire.com/en/news-release/2022/05/24/2449485/0/en/Global-Food-Service-Market-Size-to-Grow-by->

USD-4431-5-Billion-Revenue-Forecast-Company-Ranking-Competitive-Landscape-Growth-Factors-And-Trends-Vantage-Market-Research.html

XIONG, Liping, CHO, Vincent, LAW, Kris and LAM, Lianne, 2021. A study of KOL effectiveness on brand image of skincare products. *Enterprise Information Systems*. 7 May 2021. Vol. 15, p. 1–18. DOI 10.1080/17517575.2021.1924864.

## 10List of figures

- Fig. 1 Popular social networking platform for influencer marketing campaigns in Vietnam. Source: AnyMind Group, 2022. 28
- Fig. 2 Industry groups investing the most in influencer marketing in Vietnam. Source: AnyMind Group, 2022. 29
- Fig. 3 Share of respondents purchase or experience after seeing KOLs' review. Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024. 36
- Fig. 4 Social media platform preferences for following KOLs. Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210. 38
- Fig. 5 Share of respondents purchase or experience after seeing KOLs' review. Source: Online questionnaire survey, 2024, n = 210. 39

# 11List of tables

|         |                                                                                                                  |    |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| Tab. 1  | Type of influencers                                                                                              | 25 |
| Tab. 2  | Interviewees' characteristics                                                                                    | 33 |
| Tab. 3  | 5 scale Likert question to measure the level of influence of KOL's factors on consumers' purchase intention      | 35 |
| Tab. 4  | Respondents' demographic characteristics                                                                         | 36 |
| Tab. 5  | Chi-Square test of independence: Purchase or experience following KOLs x Gender                                  | 40 |
| Tab. 6  | Evaluation of respondents about their probability of experiencing recommended product and establishments         | 41 |
| Tab. 7  | Evaluation of respondents about their consumption level following popular trends on social media                 | 42 |
| Tab. 8  | Levels of consumption following popular trends on social media and age – Expected value before combination       | 43 |
| Tab. 9  | Levels of consumption following popular trends on social media and age – Expected value after combination        | 43 |
| Tab. 10 | Chi-Square test of independence: Consumption following trends on social media x Age                              | 43 |
| Tab. 11 | Evaluation of respondents about their level of consumption following popular trends on social media by age group | 44 |
| Tab. 12 | Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's trustworthines                                            | 45 |
| Tab. 13 | Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's popularity                                                | 46 |
| Tab. 14 | Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's expertise in F&B field                                    | 47 |
| Tab. 15 | Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's highly authentic content                                  | 48 |
| Tab. 16 | Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's appearance                                                | 49 |
| Tab. 17 | Evaluation of respondents about the influence of interaction of KOL's followers                                  | 50 |
| Tab. 18 | Evaluation of respondents about the influence of consumer's fondness for KOLs                                    | 50 |
| Tab. 19 | Evaluation of respondents about the influence of KOL's private life scandal                                      | 51 |

# Appendix

## A Online questionnaire survey in Vietnamese

### KHẢO SÁT SỰ ẢNH HƯỞNG CỦA KOL LÊN HÀNH VI TIÊU DÙNG CỦA NGƯỜI VIỆT NAM TRONG LĨNH VỰC F&B (THỰC PHẨM VÀ ĐỒ UỐNG)

Xin chào bạn, mình là sinh viên của trường đại học Mendel tại Cộng Hòa Séc. Hiện tại mình đang làm nghiên cứu về "**Xu hướng tiêu dùng thực phẩm và đồ uống theo KOL tại Việt Nam**". Bài khảo sát nhằm lấy những dữ kiện thực tế để phân tích về sự ảnh hưởng của KOL với hành vi tiêu dùng đồ ăn và thức uống của người Việt Nam.

Cuộc khảo sát này được ẩn danh nên bạn có thể hoàn toàn chia sẻ quan điểm một cách chân thật và trung thực nhất.

Mỗi đóng góp của bạn sẽ rất hữu ích cho bài nghiên cứu của mình.

Mời bạn bấm "**Tiếp**" (Next) để tham gia khảo sát.

\* Biểu thị câu hỏi bắt buộc

#### KOL CÓ ẢNH HƯỞNG LÊN Ý ĐỊNH MUA HÀNG CỦA BẠN ?

Nhắc nhẹ cho bạn <3

**KOL** (Key Opinion Leader) dịch sang Tiếng Việt có thể là "người dẫn dắt dư luận chủ chốt" hay "người có sức ảnh hưởng" ở trên mạng xã hội. Trong lĩnh vực F&B (thực phẩm và đồ uống), họ thường sẽ là những Food Reviewer, Food Blogger, các đầu bếp chia sẻ những công thức nấu ăn, hay những bartender nổi tiếng,...

#### 1. Bạn theo dõi những KOL trên nền tảng mạng xã hội nào? \*

Chọn tất cả mục phù hợp.

☐ Facebook

☐ Instagram

☐ Tiktok

☐ YouTube

☐ Mục khác: \_\_\_\_\_

2. Bạn đã bao giờ mua một sản phẩm (thực phẩm & đồ uống) nào đó hay \*  
là đi một hàng quán/nhà hàng nào đó sau khi xem hoặc thấy những  
đánh giá (review) và đề xuất của KOL chưa?

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

- ☐ Đã từng  
☐ Chưa bao giờ

3. Nếu bạn thích một sản phẩm nhất định (thực phẩm và đồ uống) hoặc \*  
cửa hàng/nhà hàng được KOL giới thiệu (review), xác suất bạn sẽ muốn  
trải nghiệm là bao nhiêu?

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

1 2 3 4 5

Khô ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Rất có khả năng

4. Bạn có thường xuyên ăn uống theo những xu hướng (trend) đang thịnh \*  
hành trên mạng xã hội không?

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

1 2 3 4 5

Chư ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Bắt kịp tất cả xu hướng

5. Bạn có thường xuyên giới thiệu những sản phẩm thức ăn và đồ uống/hàng quán/nhà hàng được review bởi KOL cho người quen, bạn bè không? \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.

1   2   3   4   5

Khô ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Luôn luôn

### NHỮNG YẾU TỐ CỦA KOL ẢNH HƯỞNG LÊN Ý ĐỊNH MUA HÀNG CỦA BẠN

6. Sự uy tín của KOL ảnh hưởng mạnh mẽ lên ý định mua hàng của bạn. \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.

1   2   3   4   5

Hoà ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Cực kì ảnh hưởng

7. Mức độ nổi tiếng của KOL ảnh hưởng mạnh mẽ lên ý định mua hàng của bạn. \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.

1   2   3   4   5

Hoà ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Cực kì ảnh hưởng

8. KOL có những kiến thức chuyên môn về lĩnh vực F&B ảnh hưởng tích cực đến ý định mua hàng của bạn. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.*

1 2 3 4 5

Hoà ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Cực kì ảnh hưởng

9. Những nội dung của KOL có độ chân thật cao ảnh hưởng mạnh mẽ lên ý định mua hàng của bạn. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.*

1 2 3 4 5

Hoà ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Cực kì ảnh hưởng

10. Ngoại hình của KOL ảnh hưởng mạnh mẽ lên ý định mua hàng của bạn. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.*

1 2 3 4 5

Hoà ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Cực kì ảnh hưởng

11. Bình luận hoặc phản ứng của những người theo dõi KOL làm ảnh hưởng đến ý định mua hàng của bạn. \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

1 2 3 4 5

Hoà ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Cực kì ảnh hưởng

12. Sự yêu thích của bạn đối với KOL ảnh hưởng mạnh mẽ lên ý định mua hàng của bạn. \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

1 2 3 4 5

Hoà ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Cực kì ảnh hưởng

13. KOL có nhiều tai tiếng (scandal) về đời tư ảnh hưởng mạnh mẽ đến ý định mua hàng của bạn. \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

1 2 3 4 5

Hoà ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Cực kì ảnh hưởng

14. Hãy cho mình biết điều gì thúc đẩy bạn nghe theo các đề xuất của KOL cho việc mua hàng/lựa chọn nhà hàng của bạn?

---

---

---

---

---

15. Hãy cho mình biết điều gì khiến bạn không khuyến khích nghe theo các đề xuất của KOL cho việc mua hàng/lựa chọn nhà hàng của mình?

---

---

---

---

---

16. Bạn muốn đề xuất những lời khuyên gì cho KOL để hữu ích hơn cho bạn khi bạn tìm kiếm nguồn cảm hứng mua đồ uống và thực phẩm hay lựa chọn một cửa hàng/nhà hàng?

---

---

---

---

---

17. Bạn có điều gì khác muốn chia sẻ với mình về chủ đề này không?

---

---

---

---

### CHIA SẺ NHỎ XÍU VỀ BẠN

Mình cam đoan mọi thông tin cá nhân của bạn sẽ không bị lộ ra ngoài và chỉ để dùng cho mục đích nghiên cứu.

18. Bạn có thường xuyên tự nấu ăn ở nhà không? \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.

1   2   3   4   5

Chưa ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Rất thường xuyên

19. Bạn có thường xuyên đi ăn uống ở ngoài hay mua đồ ăn thức uống ở ngoài không? \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.

1   2   3   4   5

Chưa ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Rất thường xuyên

## 20. Giới tính \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

☐ Nam

☐ Nữ

## 21. Bạn thuộc độ tuổi nào dưới đây \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

☐ Dưới 18 tuổi

☐ 18 đến 24 tuổi

☐ 25 đến 34 tuổi

☐ 35 đến 44 tuổi

☐ Trên 44 tuổi

## 22. Trình độ học vấn \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

☐ Tiểu học

☐ Trung học

☐ Đại học

☐ Sau đại học

☐ Mục khác: \_\_\_\_\_

## 23. Nghề nghiệp của bạn hay ngành học của bạn là gì? \*

\_\_\_\_\_

## 24. Tình trạng hôn nhân \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.

- ☐ Độc thân
- ☐ Đã kết hôn
- ☐ Đã kết hôn và có con
- ☐ Mục khác: \_\_\_\_\_

## 25. Nơi bạn đang sinh sống và làm việc/học tập \*

\_\_\_\_\_

CẢM ƠN BẠN ĐÃ BỎ THỜI GIAN ĐỂ THAM GIA KHẢO SÁT <3 HÃY BẤM  
"GỬI" (SEND) ĐỂ NỘP BÀI KHẢO SÁT CHO MÌNH NHÉ <3

---

Nội dung này không phải do Google tạo ra hay xác nhận.

Google Biểu mẫu

## B Online questionnaire survey in English

### SURVEYING THE INFLUENCE OF KOLS ON THE CONSUMER BEHAVIOR OF VIETNAMESE PEOPLE IN THE F&B INDUSTRY

Hello, I am currently doing research on "Food and beverage consumption trends according to KOLs in Vietnam". The survey aims to collect real data to analyze the influence of KOLs on the food and beverage consumption behavior of Vietnamese people.

To get more objective data, I hope you will share all your opinions in the most honest way.

Each of your contributions will be very helpful for my research.

Please click "**Next**" to participate in the survey.

\* Biểu thị câu hỏi bắt buộc

#### DO KOLS INFLUENCE YOUR PURCHASE INTENTION?

KOL (Key Opinion Leader) translated into Vietnamese can be a "key opinion leader" or "influencer" on social networks. In the F&B (food and beverage) field, they will often be Food Reviewers, Food Bloggers, chefs sharing recipes, or famous bartenders,...

#### 1. Which social media platforms do you follow KOLs on? \*

*Chọn tất cả mục phù hợp.*

☐ Facebook

☐ Instagram

☐ Tiktok

☐ YouTube

☐ Mục khác: \_\_\_\_\_

2. Have you ever bought a certain product (food & beverage) or gone to a certain shop/restaurant after watching or seeing reviews and recommendations from KOLs? \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.*

- ☐ Yes  
☐ Never

3. If you like a certain product (food & beverage) or certain shop/restaurant presented and recommended by KOLs online, what is the probability you would like to try to test the product yourself? \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.*

- 1 2 3 4 5  
Nev. ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very likely

4. Do you often experience following trends that are popular on social medias? \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.*

- 1 2 3 4 5  
Nev. ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Keep up with all the trends

5. Do you often recommend food and beverage products/shops/restaurants reviewed by KOLs to your acquaintances and friends? \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

1 2 3 4 5  
Nev ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Always

#### KOL FACTORS INFLUENCE YOUR PURCHASE INTENTION

6. The trustworthiness of a KOL has a strong influence on your purchase intention. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

1 2 3 4 5  
Abs ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Extremely influence

7. The popularity of a KOL has a strong influence on your purchase intention. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

1 2 3 4 5  
Abs ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Extremely influence

8. KOLs have expertise in the F&B field that positively affects your purchasing intention. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

1 2 3 4 5

Abs ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Extremely influence

9. Highly authentic content of KOLs has a strong influence on your purchasing intention. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

1 2 3 4 5

Abs ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Extremely influence

10. KOL's appearance strongly influences your purchasing intention. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

1 2 3 4 5

Abs ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Extremely influence

11. Comments or reaction of KOL followers influence your purchasing intention. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

1 2 3 4 5

Abs ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Extremely influence

12. Your fondness in KOLs strongly influences your purchasing intention. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.*

1 2 3 4 5

Abs ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Extremely influence

13. KOLs have a lot of notoriety (scandals) that strongly influence your purchasing intention. \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.*

1 2 3 4 5

Abs ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Extremely influence

14. Tell me please what motivates you to use KOL's recommendations for your shopping / choice of restaurants?

---

---

---

---

15. Tell me please what discourages you to use KOL's recommendations for your shopping / choice of restaurants?

---

---

---

---

16. What tips would you recommend to KOLs that would be more helpful to you when you are looking for inspiration to buy drinks and food or choose a store/restaurant?

---

---

---

---

---

17. Do you have anything else you would like to share with me about this topic?

---

---

---

---

---

#### A LITTLE INTRODUCTION ABOUT YOURSELF

I guarantee that all of your personal information will not be disclosed and will only be used for research purposes.

18. Do you often cook at home? \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ô van.*

1   2   3   4   5

Nev ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Always

19. Do you often eat out or buy food and drinks from outside? \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

1   2   3   4   5

Never ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Always

20. Gender \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

☐ Male

☐ Female

21. Which age group do you belong to below? \*

*Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.*

☐ Under 18

☐ 18 to 24

☐ 25 to 34

☐ 35 to 44

☐ Above 44

## 22. Education level \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

- ☐ Primary
- ☐ Highschool
- ☐ Undergraduate
- ☐ Postgraduate
- ☐ Mục khác: \_\_\_\_\_

## 23. What's your occupation? \*

\_\_\_\_\_

## 24. Family status \*

Chỉ đánh dấu một hình ôvan.

- ☐ Single
- ☐ Married
- ☐ Married with children
- ☐ Mục khác: \_\_\_\_\_

## 25. Where you live and work/study? \*

\_\_\_\_\_

THANK YOU FOR YOUR PRECIOUS TIME SPENT TO PARTICIPATE IN THE  
SURVEY <3 PLEASE CLICK "SEND" TO SUBMIT THE SURVEY <3